Braided module categories from small braidings

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Abstract

We introduce small braidings on inclusions of monoidal categories $\mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}$, which allow one to braid objects in $\mathcal{C}$ with objects in $\mathcal{D}$. A small braiding makes $\mathcal{C}$ a braided monoidal category, and $\mathcal{D}$, as well as certain subcategories of $\mathcal{D}$, a braided module category. We prove versions of previously known reconstruction results for braided module categories which do not rely on finiteness assumptions. We construct a number of new examples coming from quantum groups, as well as associated quantum moment maps.

Contents

1 Introduction **2**
1.1 Summary . . . 2
1.2 Outlook . . . 4
1.3 Physics context and motivation . . . 5
1.4 Organisation . . . 6

2 Categorical preliminaries **7**
2.1 Braided module categories . . . 8
2.2 Half-braided algebras and quantum moment maps . . . 11
2.3 Small braidings . . . 20

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3 Braided module categories for quantum groups **26**
3.1 Small braidings from unrolled quantum groups 26
3.2 Examples for quantum parameter not a root of unity 29
3.3 Quantum moment maps from internal-homs 32

A Closed monoidal categories **38**

1 Introduction

Braided monoidal categories can be thought of as monoidal categories which provide representations of the braid groups of Coxeter type A [JS93]. Adopting this intuition, *braided module categories*, first introduced in [En08], extend these representations to representations of braid groups of type B [Br13].

Braided module categories arise naturally in the Morita theory of braided monoidal categories. They are objects in the endomorphism category of the identity morphism in the 4-category of braided tensor categories [BJS21], see [Jo24, Sec. 3.3] for a proof of this, or objects in the centre of the category of module categories over a braided monoidal category [DN21, Thm. 4.11]. Braided module categories have provided a categorical interpretation of quantum K-matrices [Ko20, LWY25], and have found applications in quantum topology [BZBJ18b] and category theory [JFR24].

1.1 Summary

In this paper we present a simple new construction for braided module categories. Namely, let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ be monoidal categories and let there be an inclusion of monoidal categories $\mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}$. We define a *small braiding* (Definition 2.16) which allows one to braid objects in $\mathcal{C}$ with objects in $\mathcal{D}$. A small braiding equips $\mathcal{C}$ with a braiding and any full subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$ which is closed under tensoring with objects in $\mathcal{C}$ with the structure of a braided module category. An advantage of this construction is that it does not rely on finiteness or linearity assumptions for the categories in question. As far as the authors are aware, most current systematic approaches for constructing braided module categories result in a category which is the category of finite-dimensional modules over an algebra [Ko20], or locally finite-dimensional modules [BZBJ18b] (see also [BZBJ18a, Sec. 1.3.2]). Our approach also falls outside of the construction via reflective centres of [LWY25].

Given an algebra $A \in \mathcal{D}$, the category $\mathcal{D}_A$ of (right) A-modules in $\mathcal{D}$ is a (left) $\mathcal{D}$-module category. Furthermore, since $\mathcal{C}$ is a monoidal subcategory, $\mathcal{D}_A$ is also a $\mathcal{C}$-module category. For an algebra $A \in \mathcal{C}$, module braidings for $\mathcal{C}_A$ are known to be in bijection with half-braided structures on A [JFR24, Sec. 2.5],

and with quantum moment maps when $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon [BZBJ18b, Cor. 4.11] (see Definitions 2.10 and 2.12). If $A \in \mathcal{D}$ is not in the image of the inclusion, we can still show one direction of the bijection: A half-braided structure on A results in a module braiding for $\mathcal{D}_A$. It remains true that if $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon, half-braided structures for A are in bijection with quantum moment maps.

The definition of a small braiding is motivated by observing that the braiding for quantum groups $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ with generic quantum parameter q is well-defined on a tensor product of type 1 modules if at least one of the modules is finite-dimensional. We extend this result to braid generic weight modules with finite-dimensional type 1 modules by showing that there is a monoidal inclusion of the category of finite-dimensional type 1 modules for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ into the category of weight modules for the unrolled quantum group $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$. From this we obtain the following small braiding:

Theorem 1.1 (Theorem 3.4)**.** Let $\mathcal{C}$ be the category of finite-dimensional $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-modules of type 1 and $\mathcal{D}^H$ the category of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules. For $q \in \mathbb{C}^\times$ not a root of unity, there is a small braiding on the monoidal inclusion $\mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}^H$ given by

$$\overrightarrow{\sigma}_{C,D}(c \otimes d) = s_{C,D}\left(q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i (A^{-1})_{ij} H_i \otimes H_j} R \cdot (c \otimes d)\right) \tag{1.1a}$$

$$\overleftarrow{\sigma}_{D,C}(d \otimes c) = s_{D,C}\left(q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i (A^{-1})_{ij} H_i \otimes H_j} R \cdot (d \otimes c)\right), \tag{1.1b}$$

for all $C \in \mathcal{C}$ and $D \in \mathcal{D}^H$ with $c \in C$ and $d \in D$, respectively, where R is the R-matrix for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ and s is the swap operation on vector spaces.

Using the above theorem and basic facts about the representation theory of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ at generic quantum parameter q we describe several concrete examples coming from this small braiding:

- (Example 3.5) $\mathcal{O}_q^H$, the quantum category $\mathcal{O}$ of [AM15, Def. 3.1] for the unrolled quantum group.
- (Example 3.6) Given $\Lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*/\sim$, where $\lambda \sim \mu$ if $\lambda - \mu$ is in the weight lattice, $\mathcal{D}_\Lambda^H$, the full subcategory of $\mathcal{D}^H$ of modules with weight support in Λ.
- (Example 3.9) For $\Lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*/\sim$ q-generic, $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$ the full subcategory of $\mathcal{D}_\Lambda^H$ with objects isomorphic to a finite direct sum of Verma modules with highest weights in Λ.

In the Appendix we review how internal-end objects $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,V) =: \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$ in a monoidal category $\mathcal{D}$, if they exist, come with the canonical structure of an algebra, and how the internal-hom functor $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,-) : \mathcal{D} \to \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}$ comes with a canonical natural transformation $\Phi_{U,W}^V : U \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,W) \to \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes W)$. In Lemma A.5 we

show that $\Phi^-_{U,=}$ is an isomorphism if and only if U has a left dual. Hence $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,-)$ has the canonical structure of a module functor when we consider $\mathcal{D}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,V)}$ as module categories over a left-rigid monoidal subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$. In the $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ setting described above, $\mathcal{C}$ is a full subcategory of left-rigid objects in $\mathcal{D}$. It is then natural to ask if internal-homs exist in $\mathcal{D}$, and whether we can equip them with quantum moment maps such that $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,-)$ becomes a braided module functor.

We are able to construct quantum moment maps from the $\hbar$-adic Hopf algebra $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$, where $q = e^\hbar$ and $\hbar$ is now a formal parameter instead of a complex number. Using the fact that the category of topologically free modules $\mathcal{D}$ is closed monoidal, we construct half-braided structures on $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$ using a small braiding between the category $\mathcal{C}$ of finite rank topologically free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules and $\mathcal{D}$. Since $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon, we arrive at the following theorem.

Theorem 1.2 (Theorem 3.14)**.** Let $\mathcal{D}$ be the category of topologically free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules and $\mathcal{C}$ the category of finite rank topologically free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules. For all $V \in \mathcal{D}$ there is a canonical quantum moment map for the internal-endomorphism algebra $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$ of V.

Because the representation theory of topologically free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules is similar to that of that of $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules for q not a root of unity, we are able to work with the above examples in the $\hbar$-adic setting. In Proposition 3.16 we observe that the braided module category $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda$, which is the $\hbar$-adic analogue of $\mathcal{M}^H_\Lambda$ consisting now of finite direct sums of $\hbar$-adic Verma modules $V_\hbar(\lambda)$, satisfies sufficient conditions (Proposition A.7) such that the functor $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V_\hbar(\lambda),-) : \mathcal{M}_\Lambda \to \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V_\hbar(\lambda))}$ is a fully faithful (but not essentially surjective) braided $\mathcal{C}$-module functor.

1.2 Outlook

Our main motivation comes from an application in defect skein theory. Namely, organising defect data of skein modules according to the Morita theory of braided tensor categories [BJS21], one is led to label line defects with braided module categories and junctions between line defects with braided module functors. In upcoming work, the authors will study examples of defect skein modules with defect data coming from the examples discussed here [FrRS]. See [BZBJ18b, BJ25, G26, KR26, BGJV26, CJR26] for previous work of a similar flavour on defect skein modules.

In Remark 3.17 we show that the inclusion of braided module categories $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V_\hbar(\lambda))}$ is not an equivalence. Tools for monadic reconstruction of module categories were developed in [SZ24] precisely in order to deal with non-finite and non-rigid settings. Any $V_\hbar(\lambda) \in \mathcal{M}_\Lambda$ satisfies similar properties to the $\mathcal{C}$-projective $\mathcal{C}$-generator requirement for the reconstruction theorem [SZ24, Thm. 5.1]. It is

then natural to ask whether there is a monadic version of a quantum moment map, allowing one to reconstruct $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda$.

The quantum group setting is amenable to constructing many more examples of braided module categories from small braidings. One could study the tensor product of finite-dimensional modules with generalised Verma modules in [Mu07, Prop. 3.7] to construct braided module categories similar to $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda$. These examples should also have counterparts when the quantum parameter is specialised to a complex number. Examples beyond highest weight modules could be constructed by studying the tensor product of the torsion-free modules of [FHW15] with finite-dimensional modules.

1.3 Physics context and motivation

Many of the structures in this paper have a long history in mathematical physics, where they often appeared well before their categorical formulation. The purpose of this subsection is twofold. First, it collects the relevant physics literature in one place, so that the exposition in the main text does not have to be interrupted by these references. Second, it is meant to help readers with a background in physics to follow the constructions in the main text, by relating the categorical notions we use to their counterparts in physics.

Ribbon categories such as $\mathcal{C}$, and the skein theory built from them, are familiar from Chern–Simons theory and rational conformal field theory, where they describe Wilson lines and the braiding of chiral vertex operators [Wi89, MS89]. The additional structure of a braided module category has an equally long history in integrable systems with boundaries. Its defining relation in the braid group of type B, $\tau\sigma_1\tau\sigma_1 = \sigma_1\tau\sigma_1\tau$, is the reflection equation, which was introduced by Cherednik for the factorised scattering of particles on a half-line [Ch84] and by Sklyanin for integrable spin chains with boundaries [Sk88]. The module braiding plays the role of the boundary K-matrix, and the spectral-parameter-independent reflection equation relevant here was studied, together with its relation to quantum groups, in [KS92]. In this language, the axioms (2.7a) and (2.7b) satisfied by the module braiding express the dressing of a boundary by an additional site [Sk88] and the fusion of K-matrices [MN92].

The coend $\mathcal{L}$, quantum moment maps (Definition 2.12) and internal endomorphism algebras (cf. Theorem 3.14) also appeared in the combinatorial quantisation of Chern–Simons theory [AGS95, AGS96, BR95]. There, $\mathcal{L}$ is the algebra generated by the holonomy around a single puncture. Its defining relations are those of the reflection equation algebra of [KS92], and this loop algebra is closely related to the quantum group itself [Al94], via the map φ of Remark 3.15. A quantum moment map $\mu\colon \mathcal{L} \to A$ realises the holonomy in an algebra A, and the moment map condition (2.28) expresses that conjugation by the holonomy implements the quantum

gauge symmetry. For a puncture carrying a representation V, the holonomy acts on V through $R_{21}R$ [AS96], which is formula (3.33), and quantum Hamiltonian reduction along such maps underlies the moduli algebras of [AGS96]. Classically, these structures quantise the group-valued moment maps of [AMM98]. The images $\mu(\mathcal{L}) \subset \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$, i.e. quantised conjugacy classes, arose independently in string theory as world-volume algebras of D-branes in WZW models, which are localised along conjugacy classes and become fuzzy spheres at large level [ARS99]. More generally, internal endomorphism algebras organise boundary fields in the topological field theory construction of conformal field theory correlators [FuRS02].

Finally, our main motivation, the use of braided module categories $\mathcal{M}$ as labels of line defects in skein theory (Section 1.2), has a counterpart in four-dimensional gauge theory. These line defects have codimension two: a Wilson line labelled by $U \in \mathcal{C}$ that winds around a defect line carrying $M \in \mathcal{M}$ picks up the module braiding $e_{U,M}$, which reduces to the double braiding for $\mathcal{M} = \mathcal{C}$ (Remark 2.6). In gauge theory, codimension-two defects are the surface operators of Gukov and Witten, defined by a prescribed singularity of the gauge field that fixes the conjugacy class of the monodromy around them [GW06], and Wilson lines of Chern–Simons theory can be described as codimension-two monodromy defects [Wi12]. Finite-dimensional modules then give Wilson lines with quantised monodromy, while Verma modules of generic weight label defects with generic monodromy. The same distinction appears in Liouville theory with $q = e^{i\pi b^2}$ [Te95]: degenerate fields act on generic primaries V_α as finite-dimensional modules act on the Verma modules of Example 3.9 with $\lambda + 1 = (Q - 2\alpha)/b$, and their monodromy is given by the module braiding. For $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sl}_2$, the category $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$ also describes the $U_q\mathfrak{sl}_2$-invariant open XXZ chain [PS90] with a Verma module at the boundary [CGS22], whose commutant is the blob algebra [MS94]. In the morphism spaces of $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$ one can find the morphism spaces of the blob category of [ILZ19, LNV21] and hence also the blob algebras of [MS94].

1.4 Organisation

In Section 2.1 we review the basics of braided module categories and braided module functors. Then in Section 2.2 we review the construction of braided module categories via half-braided algebras and quantum moment maps. We then introduce small braidings in Section 2.3, and establish generalised versions of half-braided algebras and quantum moment maps. In Section 3 we study braided module categories coming from quantum groups. We begin by discussing the small braiding between finite-dimensional type 1 modules for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ and weight modules for $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ in Section 3.1. We then introduce concrete examples in this setting in Section 3.2. We conclude in Section 3.3 by switching settings to the $\hbar$-adic quantum group, where we construct half-braided algebras and quantum moment maps using internal-

homs. In Appendix A we prove some results about algebras in closed categories which we use in Section 3.3.

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AI usage disclosure

During the preparation of this manuscript we used Claude and ChatGPT to search for relevant literature, as well as to proof-read a draft during the final editing. None of the text or diagrams in this manuscript are generated by AI. We hold full responsibility for the validity of the results in this manuscript.

2 Categorical preliminaries

In this section we review the notion of a braided module category over a braided monoidal category and its corresponding graphical calculus. We then review the results of [BZBJ18b] and [JFR24] which construct braided module categories from so-called quantum moment maps and half-braided algebras respectively. Finally, we define small braidings, and develop the analogues of quantum moment maps and half-braided algebras in this new setting.

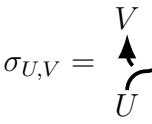
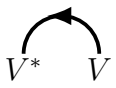
Given a category $\mathcal{C}$ and $U, V \in \mathcal{C}$, we denote the space of morphisms $U \to V$ as $\mathcal{C}(U, V)$. Our conventions for a braided monoidal category $(\mathcal{C}, \otimes, \mathbb{1}, \alpha, l, r, \sigma)$ follow those of [Ka95, Chs. XI-XIII]. Namely, the direction of the associator is

$$\alpha : (- \otimes =) \otimes = \Rightarrow - \otimes (= \otimes =) \ . \tag{2.1}$$

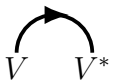
Our convention and notation for a rigid monoidal category is the same as that of [EGNO15, Sec. 2.10]. We define a ribbon category as in [EGNO15, Def. 8.10.1]. We abbreviate the identity morphism on objects id_V by simply writing the object V when there is no ambiguity in doing so.

We frequently employ a diagrammatic calculus for braided and rigid monoidal categories. Diagrams are to be read from the bottom up, with the structural

morphisms being depicted as

$\sigma_{U,V} =$  , $\mathrm{ev}_V =$  , $\mathrm{coev}_V =$  , (2.2)

and for when our category has pivotal structure $\delta_V : V \to V^{**}$,

$\mathrm{ev}_{V^*} \circ (\delta_V \otimes V^*) =$  , $(V^* \otimes \delta_V^{-1}) \circ \mathrm{coev}_{V^*} =$  . (2.3)

2.1 Braided module categories

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a braided monoidal category.

Definition 2.1 ([EGNO15, Def. 7.1.2])**.** A *(left) $\mathcal{C}$-module category* is a category $\mathcal{M}$ along with an *action bifunctor* $- \triangleright = : \mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{M} \to \mathcal{M}$ and a *modulator*, which is a natural isomorphism

$$\alpha^{\mathcal{M}} : (- \otimes =) \triangleright \equiv \Rightarrow - \triangleright (= \triangleright \equiv) \,, \tag{2.4}$$

as well as a unitor isomorphism $l^{\mathcal{M}} : \mathbb{1} \triangleright - \Rightarrow \mathrm{id}_{\mathcal{M}}$. The modulator is required to satisfy the mixed pentagon identity, and the unitor the mixed triangle identity, both of which can be found in [EGNO15, Sec. 7.1].

Example 2.2 ([EGNO15, Sec. 7.8])**.** Let (A, m, u) be an algebra in $\mathcal{C}$. The category $\mathcal{C}_A$ of right A-modules in $\mathcal{C}$ is a left $\mathcal{C}$-module category.

Definition 2.3 ([EGNO15, Def. 7.2.1])**.** A *$\mathcal{C}$-module functor* $F : (\mathcal{M}, \triangleright) \to (\mathcal{N}, \triangleright)$ is a functor $F : \mathcal{M} \to \mathcal{N}$ together with a natural isomorphisms $F_{-,=} : - \triangleright F(=) \Rightarrow F(- \triangleright =)$ such that the diagrams

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 & (U \otimes V) \triangleright F(M) & \\
{\scriptstyle \alpha^{\mathcal{N}}}\swarrow & & \searrow{\scriptstyle F_{U\otimes V,M}} \\
U \triangleright (V \triangleright F(M)) & & F((U \otimes V) \triangleright M) \\
{\scriptstyle U \triangleright F_{V,M}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle F(\alpha^{\mathcal{M}})} \\
U \triangleright F(V \triangleright M) & \xrightarrow{\quad F_{U,V\triangleright M} \quad} & F(U \triangleright (V \triangleright M))
\end{array} \,, \tag{2.5a}$$

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
F(\mathbb{1} \triangleright M) & \xrightarrow{\quad F_{\mathbb{1},M} \quad} & \mathbb{1} \triangleright' F(M) \\
 & {\scriptstyle F(l^{\mathcal{M}}_M)}\searrow \quad \swarrow{\scriptstyle l^{\mathcal{N}}_{F(M)}} & \\
 & F(M) &
\end{array} \tag{2.5b}$$

commute for all objects U, V in $\mathcal{C}$ and M in $\mathcal{M}$.

Example 2.4 ([EGNO15, Sec. 7.8])**.** Assume $\mathcal{C}$ is in addition abelian and that the tensor product is right exact. Let (A, m, u) and (B, m', u') be algebras in $\mathcal{C}$ and M be an (A, B)-bimodule in $\mathcal{C}$. The functor $- \otimes_A M : \mathcal{C}_A \to \mathcal{C}_B$ is a $\mathcal{C}$-module functor.

Definition 2.5. A *(left) braided $\mathcal{C}$-module category* is a $\mathcal{C}$-module category $(\mathcal{M}, \triangleright, \alpha^{\mathcal{M}}, l^{\mathcal{M}})$ along with a *module braiding*, which is a natural automorphism of the action functor

$$e_{-,=} : - \triangleright = \to - \triangleright = , \tag{2.6}$$

such that the the following diagrams commute for all $M \in \mathcal{M}$ and $U, V \in \mathcal{C}$:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
(U \otimes V) \triangleright M & \xrightarrow{\sigma_{U,V} \triangleright M} & (V \otimes U) \triangleright M \\
{\scriptstyle \alpha^{\mathcal{M}}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \alpha^{\mathcal{M}}} \\
U \triangleright (V \triangleright M) & & V \triangleright (U \triangleright M) \\
{\scriptstyle e_{U,V \triangleright M}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle V \triangleright e_{U,M}} \\
U \triangleright (V \triangleright M) & & V \triangleright (U \triangleright M) \\
{\scriptstyle (\alpha^{\mathcal{M}})^{-1}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle (\alpha^{\mathcal{M}})^{-1}} \\
(U \otimes V) \triangleright M & \xleftarrow{\sigma_{V,U} \triangleright M} & (V \otimes U) \triangleright M
\end{array} \tag{2.7a}$$

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
(U \otimes V) \triangleright M & & \xrightarrow{\quad e_{U \otimes V, M} \quad} & & (U \otimes V) \triangleright M \\
{\scriptstyle \sigma^{-1}_{V,U} \triangleright M}\downarrow & & & & \uparrow{\scriptstyle (\alpha^{\mathcal{M}})^{-1}} \\
(V \otimes U) \triangleright M & & & & U \triangleright (V \triangleright M) \\
{\scriptstyle \alpha^{\mathcal{M}}}\downarrow & & & & \uparrow{\scriptstyle U \triangleright e_{V,M}} \\
V \triangleright (U \triangleright M) & & & & U \triangleright (V \triangleright M) \\
{\scriptstyle V \triangleright e_{U,M}}\downarrow & & & & \uparrow{\scriptstyle \alpha^{\mathcal{M}}} \\
V \triangleright (U \triangleright M) & & & & (U \otimes V) \triangleright M \\
& {\scriptstyle (\alpha^{\mathcal{M}})^{-1}} \searrow & & \nearrow {\scriptstyle \sigma_{V,U} \triangleright M} & \\
& & (V \otimes U) \triangleright M & &
\end{array} \tag{2.7b}$$

We note that naturality of the associativity and unitor isomorphisms and condition (2.7b) for $U = V = \mathbb{1}$ imply $e_{\mathbb{1},M} = e_{\mathbb{1},M} \circ e_{\mathbb{1},M}$. Since $e_{\mathbb{1},M}$ is an isomorphism, this gives $e_{\mathbb{1},M} = \mathrm{id}_{\mathbb{1} \triangleright M}$.

Remark 2.6. Braided module categories were first introduced in [En08]. Several different conventions have emerged regarding their definition, the complete

list (to the authors' knowledge) being [En08, Sec. 4.3], [Br13, Sec. 5.1], [BZBJ18b, Def. 3.4], [Ko20, Def. 2.1], [DN21, Def. 4.1], [JFR24, Sec. 2.2] and [LWY25, Def. 3.5]. We choose the same convention as [LWY25, Def. 3.5], allowing for $\mathcal{C}$ to be a braided module category over itself with module braiding $e_{U,V} = \sigma_{V,U} \circ \sigma_{U,V}$. Every definition listed is equivalent when the appropriate assumptions are made on $\mathcal{C}$, see [LWY25, Rem. 3.15] for a detailed comparison.

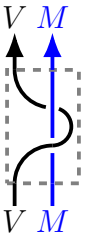
Remark 2.7. It is a standard result that any monoidal category is monoidally equivalent to a strict monoidal category (see for example [EGNO15, Thm. 2.8.5]). A similar result applies for module categories: A $\mathcal{C}$-module category is equivalent to a module category over the strictification of $\mathcal{C}$ such that the mixed associator and unitor are identities [Br13, Sec. 5.1]. We call such a module category a *strict module category*.

Definition 2.8. A $\mathcal{C}$-module functor $F : (\mathcal{M}, \triangleright) \to (\mathcal{N}, \triangleright')$ of braided module categories $(\mathcal{M}, e)$ and $(\mathcal{N}, e')$ is *braided* if the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V \triangleright' F(M) & \xrightarrow{e'_{V,F(M)}} & V \triangleright' F(M) \\ {\scriptstyle F_{V,M}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle F_{V,M}} \\ F(V \triangleright M) & \xrightarrow{F(e_{V,M})} & F(V \triangleright M) \end{array} \tag{2.8}$$

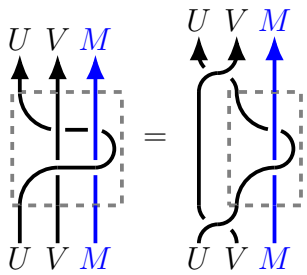
commutes for all $V \in \mathcal{C}$, $M \in \mathcal{M}$.

Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a braided $\mathcal{C}$-module category. We use the following graphical notation for the module braiding.

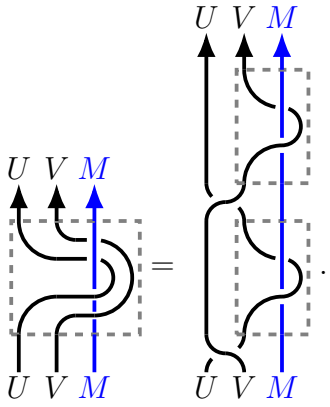
$e_{V,M} =$ 

(2.9)

The graphical notation for a braided module category implicitly uses the equivalence to a strict braided module category over a strict braided monoidal category. The conditions (2.7a) and (2.7b) are quite natural in the graphical notation,



(2.10a)



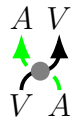
(2.10b)

2.2 Half-braided algebras and quantum moment maps

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a braided monoidal category.

In [JFR24] the theory of half-braided algebras, including the results of this section, was developed under the assumption that $\mathcal{C}$ is a fusion category. However, neither semisimplicity, rigidity, nor finiteness is required in the proofs of the statements we use. We include the proofs below as we refer to them in the sequel.

Proposition 2.9. [JFR24, Lemma 2.38] Let (A, m, u) be an algebra in $\mathcal{C}$. There is a bijective correspondence between module braidings for $\mathcal{C}_A$, and half-braidings $\gamma^A : - \otimes A \xRightarrow{\sim} A \otimes -$, depicted

$\gamma^A_V =$  ,

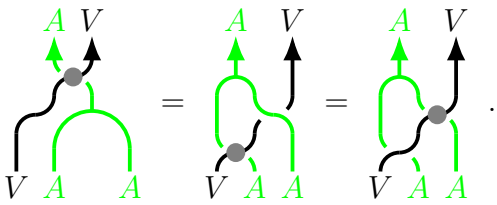
(2.11)

satisfying the hexagon [EGNO15, Eq. (7.41)], such that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
 & & (A\otimes V)\otimes A & \xrightarrow{(A\otimes\sigma^{-1}_{A,V})\circ\alpha} & A\otimes(A\otimes V) & & \\
 & \nearrow{\scriptstyle \gamma^A_V\otimes A} & & & & \searrow{\scriptstyle (m\otimes V)\circ\alpha^{-1}} & \\
(V\otimes A)\otimes A & & \xrightarrow{(V\otimes m)\circ\alpha} & V\otimes A & \xrightarrow{\gamma^A_V} & & A\otimes V \\
 & \searrow{\scriptstyle \sigma_{V,A}\otimes A} & & & & \nearrow{\scriptstyle (m\otimes V)\circ\alpha^{-1}} & \\
 & & (A\otimes V)\otimes A & \xrightarrow[(A\otimes\gamma^A_V)\circ\alpha]{} & A\otimes(A\otimes V) & &
\end{array}$$

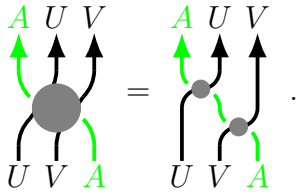
(2.12)

commutes for all objects V in $\mathcal{C}$. The condition (2.12) is depicted



(2.13)

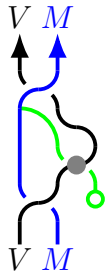
For all $U, V \in \mathcal{C}$, the hexagon [EGNO15, Eq. (7.41)] is depicted



(2.14)

Proof. The proof is essentially identical to that of [JFR24, Lemma 2.38], although our convention differs from theirs. We reproduce it string-diagrammatically. We show via a direct computation that a module braiding can be obtained from a half-braiding via

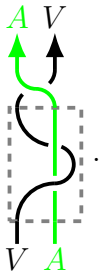
$e_{V,M} :=$



(2.15)

and a half-braiding from a module braiding via

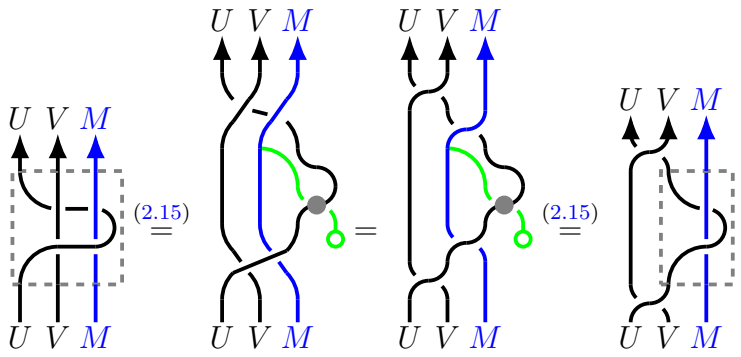
$\gamma_V^A :=$



(2.16)

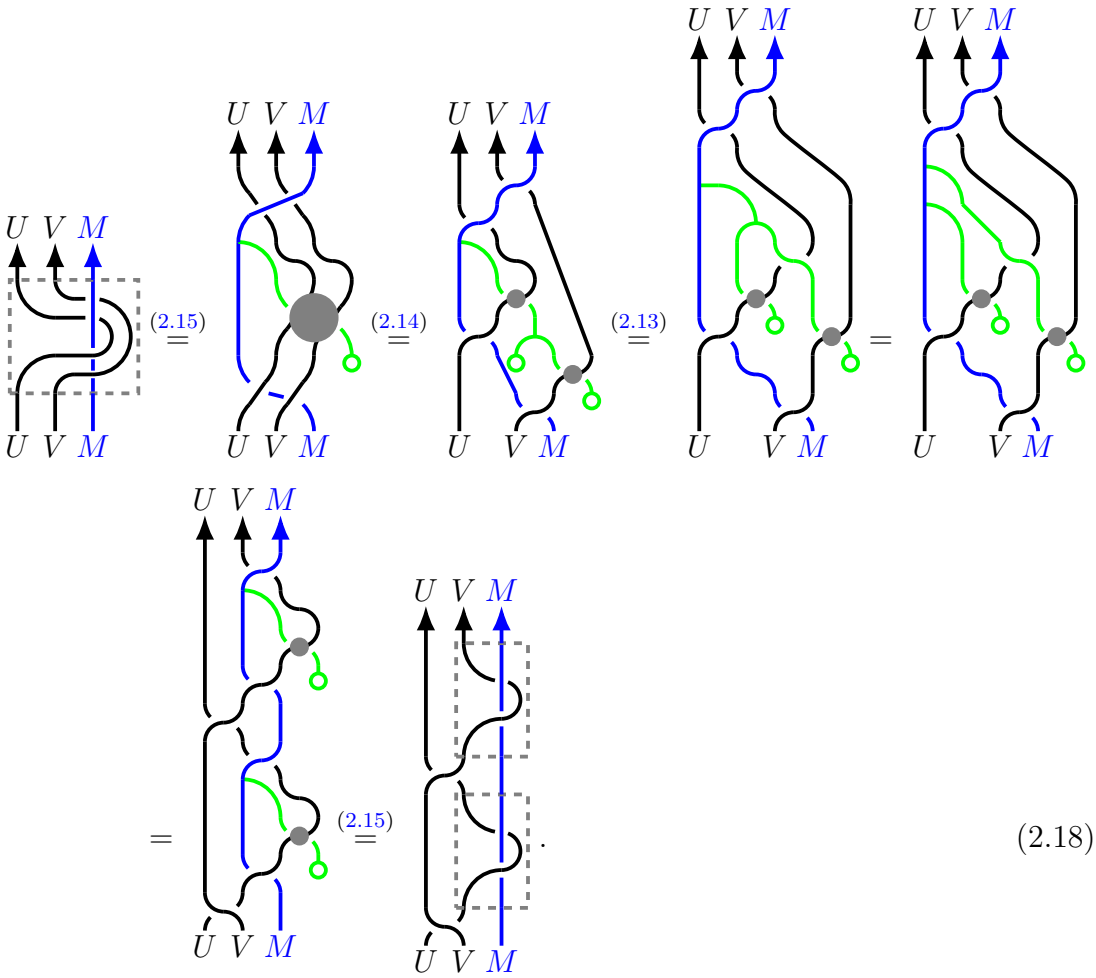
Let U, V be objects in $\mathcal{C}$ and (M, ρ) an object in $\mathcal{C}_A$. Note that $V \triangleright M = (V \otimes M, V \otimes \rho)$ in the strict setting. Because γ^A is a natural isomorphism, the

natural transformation $e_{-,=}$ defined in (2.15) is a natural isomorphism. Now we show that it satisfies the condition (2.10a):



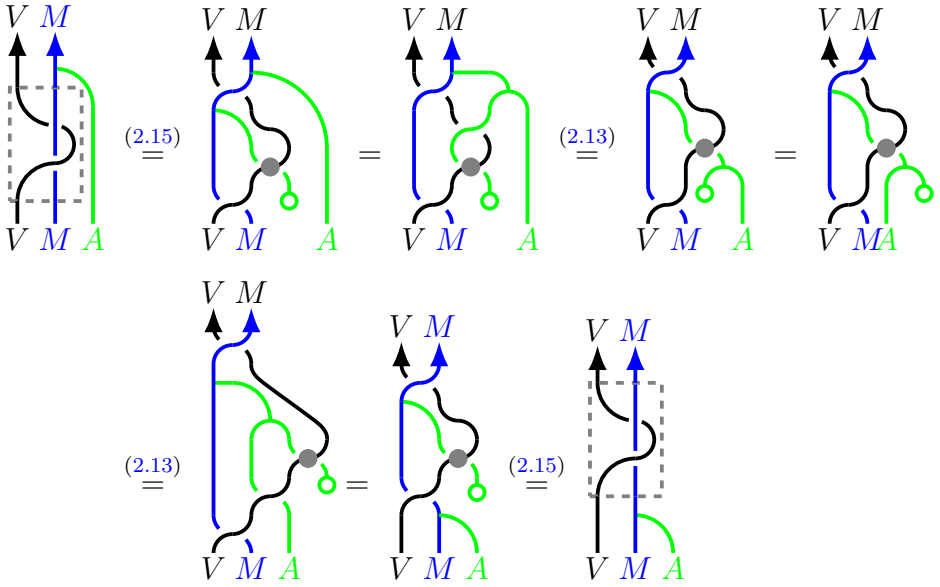
(2.17)

Now for the condition (2.10b):



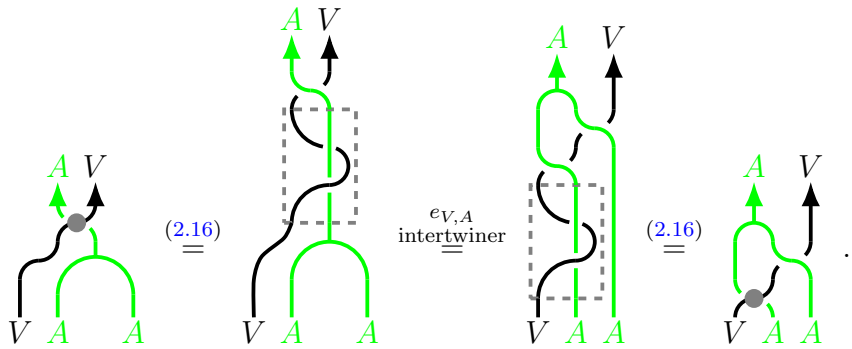
(2.18)

Finally, we show that each $e_{V,M}$ is a morphism in $\mathcal{C}_A$ (i.e. an intertwiner of A-modules):



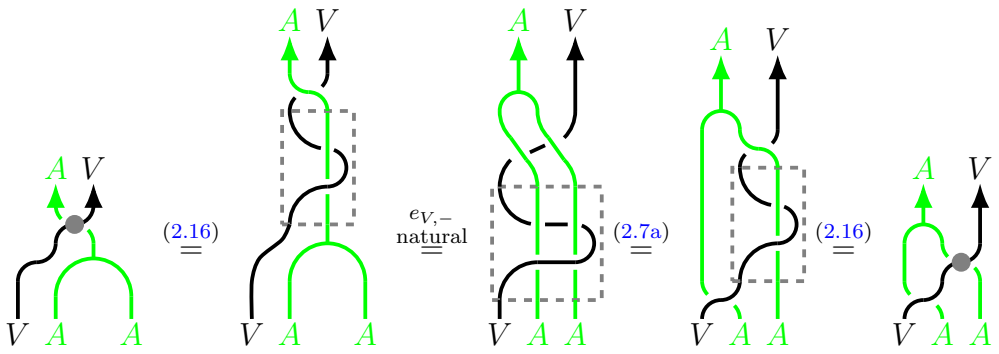
(2.19)

Now let us show that γ^A in (2.16) is a half-braiding. It is invertible by virtue of the fact that the module braidings and braiding in $\mathcal{C}$ are invertible. The hexagon [EGNO15, Eq. (7.41)] is also a straightforward string diagram computation using the hexagon for the braiding and the conditions (2.10a) and (2.10b). We check the condition (2.13) directly. The first equality in (2.13) follows from



(2.20)

The second equality in (2.13) follows from



(2.21)

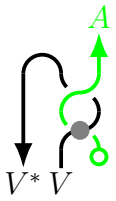
Showing that the assignments (2.15) and (2.16) are mutually inverse is a straightforward computation using the properties of half-braidings and module braidings. □

Definition 2.10. [JFR24, Def. 2.31] An algebra (A, m, u) in $\mathcal{C}$ equipped with a half-braiding γ^A satisfying (2.13) is called a *half-braided algebra*.

Remark 2.11. Setting $A = \mathbb{1}$ with the canonical (trivial) algebra we observe that a module braiding for the regular $\mathcal{C}$-module category is equivalent to a monoidal natural automorphism of the identity functor, recovering [HS26, Prop. 2.2].

Assume $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon. From a half-braiding for an algebra $A \in \mathcal{C}$ we obtain a dinatural transformation $j : (-)^* \otimes = : \ddot{\to} A$ as follows:

$$j_V := \quad \text{(2.22)}$$



The universal recipient of dinatural transformations is the coend of the functor $(-)^* \otimes = : \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{op}} \times \mathcal{C} \to \mathcal{C}$, and is denoted

$$\mathcal{L} = \int^{V \in \mathcal{C}} V^* \otimes V \ . \tag{2.23}$$

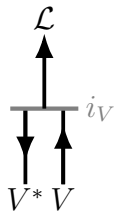
See [KL01, Ch. 5] for a detailed review of coends in braided monoidal categories. Assume $\mathcal{L}$ exists as an object in $\mathcal{C}$. By definition, it comes equipped with a dinatural transformation $i = (i_V : V^* \otimes V \to \mathcal{L})_{V \in \mathcal{C}}$ satisfying the following

universal property: Given $A \in \mathcal{C}$ and a dinatural transformation $j : (-)^* \otimes = : \ddot{\to} A$, there exists a unique morphism $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to A$ in $\mathcal{C}$ such that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & V^* \otimes V & & \\ & {\scriptstyle i_V} \swarrow & & \searrow {\scriptstyle j_V} & \\ \mathcal{L} & & \xrightarrow[\mu]{} & & A \end{array} \tag{2.24}$$

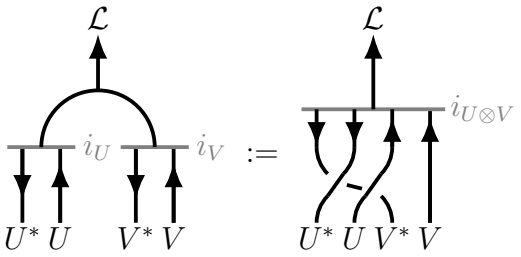
commutes for all V in $\mathcal{C}$. We depict the dinatural transformation i graphically as

$$i_V = \quad . \tag{2.25}$$

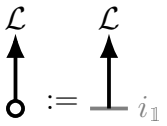


Because $\mathcal{C}$ is rigid, $- \otimes V$ and $V \otimes -$ admit right adjoints and hence preserve all colimits. In particular, they preserve $\mathcal{L}$ for all $V \in \mathcal{C}$. Thus the object $\mathcal{L} \otimes \mathcal{L}$ is exhibited as a coend over $\mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{C}$ with dinatural transformation $(i_U \otimes i_V)_{U,V \in \mathcal{C}}$. The morphisms $m : \mathcal{L} \otimes \mathcal{L} \to \mathcal{L}$ and $u : \mathbb{1} \to \mathcal{L}$ defined via

$$m \circ (i_U \otimes i_V) = \quad := \quad , \tag{2.26a}$$



$$u = \quad := \quad \tag{2.26b}$$

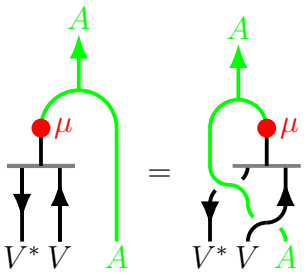


make $(\mathcal{L}, m, u)$ an algebra in $\mathcal{C}$.

Definition 2.12. Assume $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon and contains the coend $\mathcal{L}$. Let (A, m, u) be an algebra in $\mathcal{C}$. A *quantum moment map* is an algebra homomorphism $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to A$ in $\mathcal{C}$ such that

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} (V^* \otimes V) \otimes A & \xrightarrow{(\mu \circ i_V) \otimes A} & A \otimes A & \xrightarrow{\quad m \quad} & A \\ {\scriptstyle (V^* \otimes \sigma_{V,A}) \circ \alpha} \downarrow & & & & \uparrow {\scriptstyle m} \\ V^* \otimes (A \otimes V) & \xrightarrow[(\sigma^{-1}_{A,V^*} \otimes V) \circ \alpha^{-1}]{} & A \otimes (V^* \otimes V) & \xrightarrow[(A \otimes (\mu \circ i_V)) \circ \alpha]{} & A \otimes A \end{array} \tag{2.27}$$

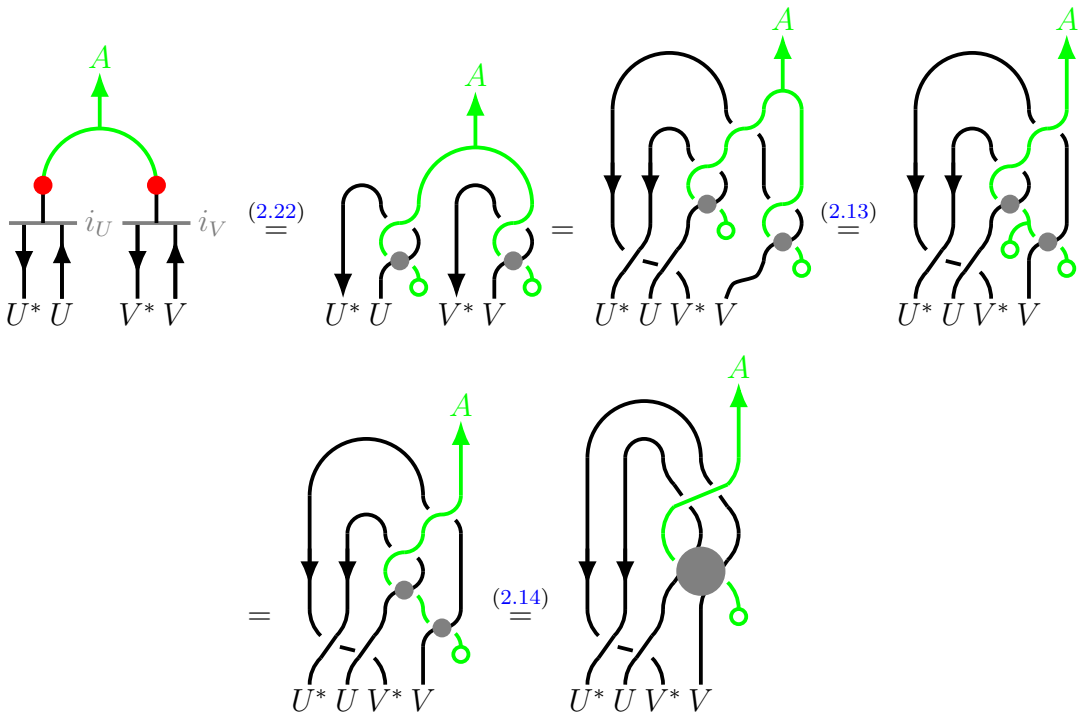
for all $V \in \mathcal{C}$. This condition is depicted

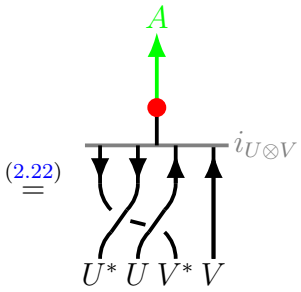


(2.28)

Proposition 2.13 ([JFR24, Sec. 2.5])**.** Assume $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon and contains the coend $\mathcal{L}$. Given an algebra $A \in \mathcal{C}$, there is a bijective correspondence between half-braidings and quantum moment maps for A.

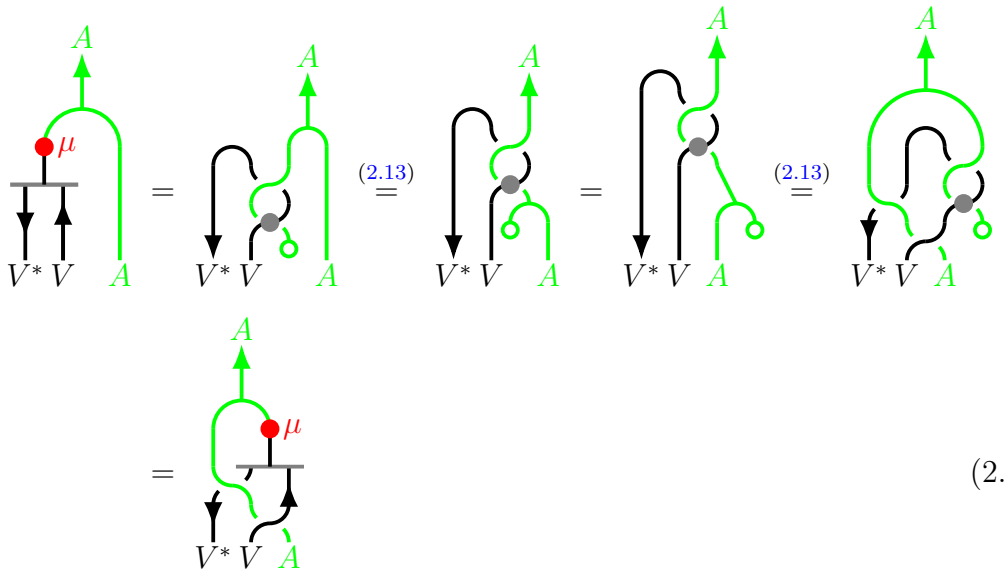
Proof. First we show that a half-braiding can be used to construct a quantum moment map. From (2.22) we can construct a dinatural transformation from a half-braiding, and the universal property of the coend implies that there exists a unique morphism $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to A$. We now show that μ obtained this way is a quantum moment map. First, we show that it is an algebra homomorphism:





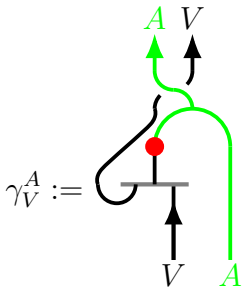
(2.29)

Preservation of the unit is clear from $\gamma^A_{\mathbb{1}} = \mathrm{id}_A$, which follows from the hexagon for γ^A. Now we show that the quantum moment map condition (2.28) is satisfied:



(2.30)

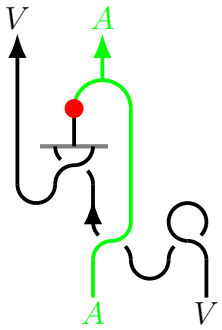
Now we consider the other direction. Given a quantum moment map $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to A$, we define a natural transformation $\gamma^A : - \otimes A \Rightarrow A \otimes -$ via



(2.31)

Dinaturality of $i : (-)^* \otimes = \dddot{\to} \mathcal{L}$ and naturality of the pivotal structure imply γ^A is natural. A straightforward string diagram computation shows that γ^A satisfies the

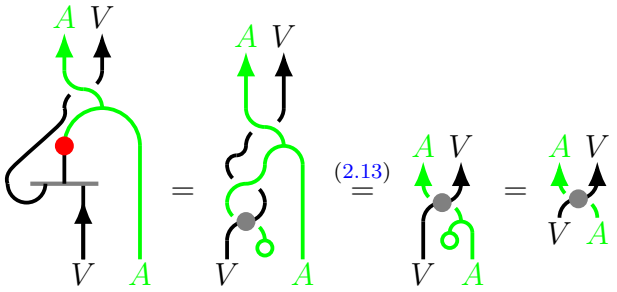
hexagons and conditions of a half-braiding from Proposition 2.9. A computation using (2.26a), (2.26b), dinaturality of i and the zig-zag identities shows that

$(\gamma_V^A)^{-1} :=$ 

, (2.32)

provides an inverse for γ_V^A.

Finally, we show that these constructions are mutually inverse by inserting the quantum moment map obtained from the half-braiding (2.22) into (2.31), to obtain the half-braiding back:



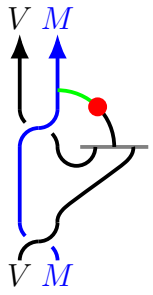
. (2.33)

A similar computation shows that inserting the quantum moment map (2.22) into the half-braiding (2.31) results in the original half-braiding, so the constructions are mutually inverse. □

Combining Propositions 2.9 and 2.13, we arrive at the following result.

Corollary 2.14. [BZBJ18b, Cor. 4.11] Assume $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon and contains the coend $\mathcal{L}$. Let (A, m, u) be an algebra in $\mathcal{C}$. There is a bijective correspondence between module braidings for $\mathcal{C}_A$ and quantum moment maps $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to A$. In this correspondence, a module braiding is constructed from a quantum moment map

via

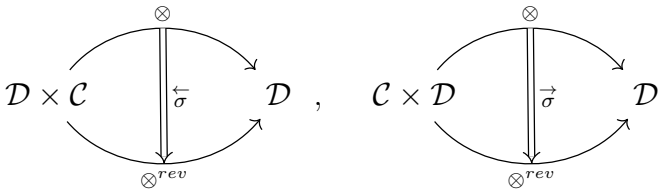
$e_{V,M} =$  . (2.34)

Remark 2.15. The pair (A, γ^A) is an object in the Drinfeld centre $Z(\mathcal{C})$ of $\mathcal{C}$. However, equipping the Drinfeld centre with the canonical monoidal structure which turns it into a braided monoidal category (see [EGNO15, Sec. 8.5]), the conditions (2.13) do not allow one to lift the algebra structure to an algebra structure in the Drinfeld centre. In [BZBJ18b, Cor. 4.6] (see also [JFR24, Def. 2.47]) it was observed that if $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon, one can use the equivalence between $\mathcal{C}_{\mathcal{L}}$ and $Z(\mathcal{C})$ to define an alternative monoidal structure on $Z(\mathcal{C})$ such that a half-braided algebra in $\mathcal{C}$ lifts to an algebra in $Z(\mathcal{C})$. The category $\mathcal{C}_{\mathcal{L}}$ with this monoidal structure is sometimes called the *Harish-Chandra category* [GJS23, Sec. 2.5], see *loc. cit.* for details regarding its definition.

2.3 Small braidings

Let $(\mathcal{D}, \otimes, \mathbb{1}, \alpha, l, r)$ be a monoidal category, $\mathcal{C} \overset{\iota}{\hookrightarrow} \mathcal{D}$ a full monoidal subcategory, and $\otimes^{rev}$ the reversed tensor product: $U \otimes^{rev} V = V \otimes U$.

Definition 2.16. A *small braiding for* $\mathcal{C} \overset{\iota}{\hookrightarrow} \mathcal{D}$ is the data of two natural isomorphisms[1]

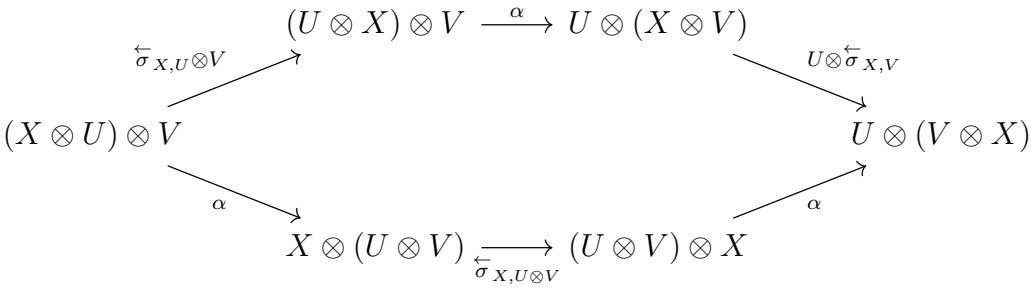


(2.35)

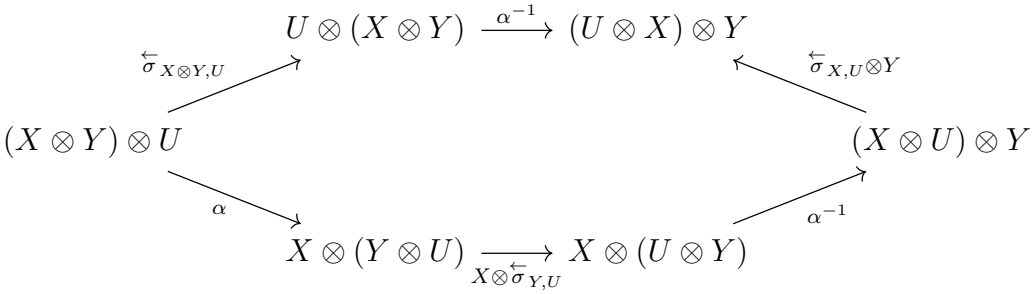
which agree on $\mathcal{C}$, (for all $U, V \in \mathcal{C}$, one has $\overleftarrow{\sigma}_{U,\iota V} = \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{\iota U,V}$) and satisfy the hexagon

[1] One way to remember the convention for the arrow on σ is that for the source objects, it points the same way as ι, namely $\mathcal{C} \to \mathcal{D}$. For example, $\overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,X}$ has $U \in \mathcal{C}$ and $X \in \mathcal{D}$.

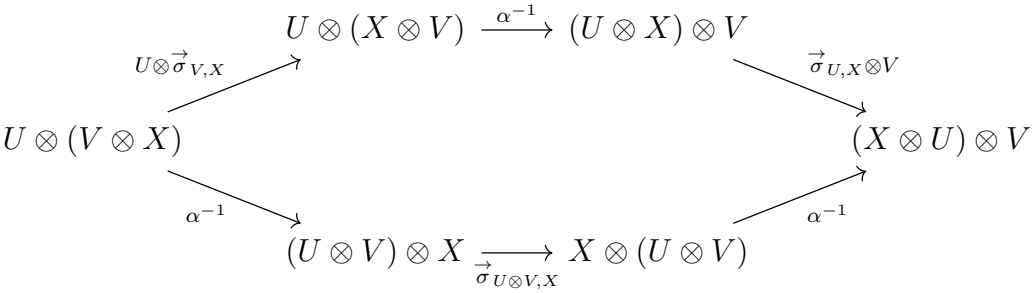
constraints: For all $U, V \in \mathcal{C}$ and $X, Y \in \mathcal{D}$ the following diagrams commute.



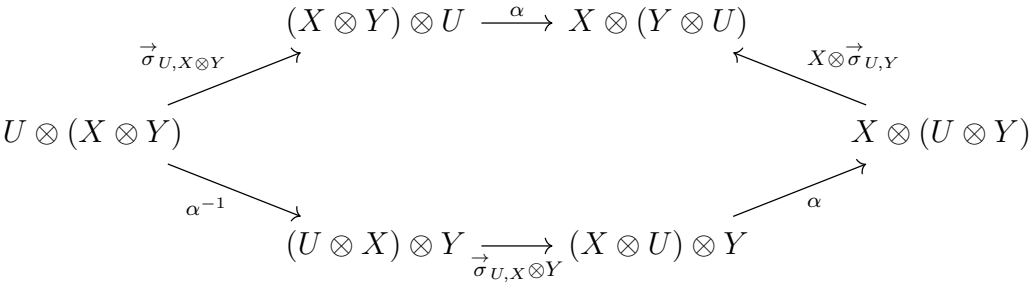
(2.36a)



(2.36b)



(2.36c)

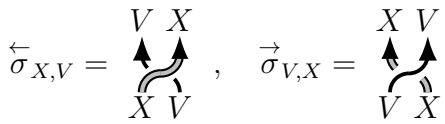


(2.36d)

We depict a small braiding similarly to a regular braiding by using a thicker

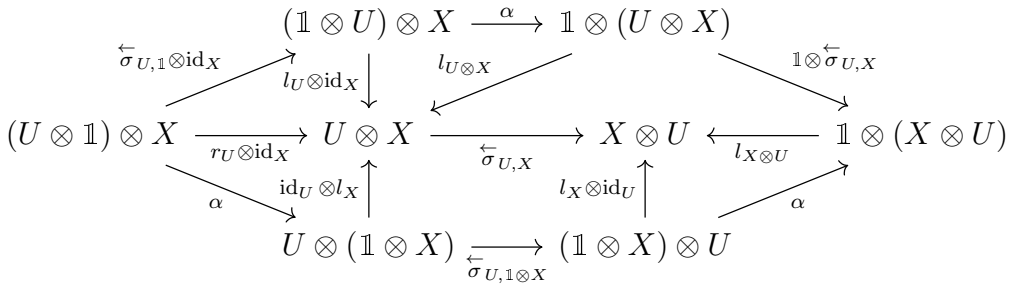
line to indicate the object which comes from $\mathcal{D}$:

$$\overleftarrow{\sigma}_{X,V} = \quad , \qquad \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{V,X} = \quad . \tag{2.37}$$



Lemma 2.17. A small braiding on $(\mathcal{C} \overset{\iota}{\hookrightarrow} \mathcal{D}, \overleftarrow{\sigma}, \overrightarrow{\sigma})$ endows $\mathcal{C}$ with the structure of a braided monoidal category, and $l_U \circ \overleftarrow{\sigma}_{U,\mathbb{1}} = r_U$ and $r_U \circ \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{\mathbb{1},U} = l_U$ for all $U \in \mathcal{D}$.

Proof. Since $\overleftarrow{\sigma}$ and $\overrightarrow{\sigma}$ agree on $\mathcal{C}$, their respective hexagons together define a braiding for $\mathcal{C}$. The unitality property $l_U \circ \overleftarrow{\sigma}_{U,\mathbb{1}} = r_U$ follows from setting $W = \mathbb{1}$ in (2.36a) and inserting unitors in the interior as follows (cf. [Ka95, Prop. XIII.1.2]):



(2.38)

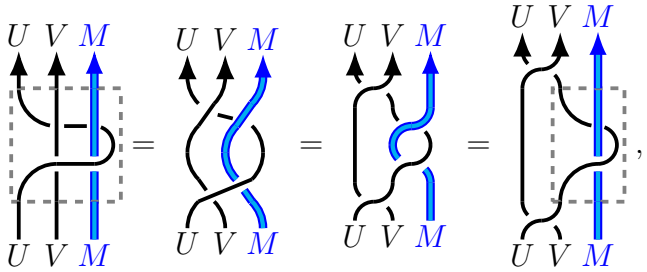
The square in the top half of the hexagon commutes via naturality of the unitor, and the square in the bottom half commutes from naturality of $\overleftarrow{\sigma}$. The two triangles adjacent to the top left triangle as well as the bottom right triangle commute from the definition of the unitor. Thus the top left triangle commutes, which gives us the result upon setting $X = \mathbb{1}$ and using the right unitor. The property $r_U \circ \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{\mathbb{1},U} = l_U$ can be proven by filling in the hexagon (2.36c) similarly. □

In all sections that follow we denote with σ the underlying braiding in $\mathcal{C}$ coming from a small braiding $(\overleftarrow{\sigma}, \overrightarrow{\sigma})$ on $\mathcal{C} \overset{\iota}{\hookrightarrow} \mathcal{D}$. We also suppress coherence morphisms.

Proposition 2.18. Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a full subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$ such that $\iota V \otimes M$ is an object in $\mathcal{M}$ for all objects V in $\mathcal{C}$ and M in $\mathcal{M}$. Then $(\mathcal{M}, \overleftarrow{\sigma} \circ \overrightarrow{\sigma})$ is a braided left $\mathcal{C}$-module category with action functor $\iota \otimes -$.

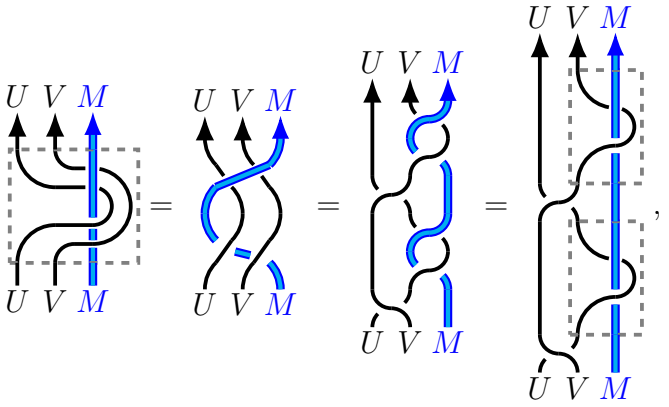
Proof. Let $\mathcal{M}$ be as above. The $\mathcal{C}$-module structure is given by the monoidal structure for $\mathcal{D}$. Let $U, V \in \mathcal{C}$ and $M \in \mathcal{M}$. The identities for $\overleftarrow{\sigma} \circ \overrightarrow{\sigma}$ we need to

verify are (2.7a) and (2.7b). The identity (2.7a) follows from



(2.39)

where in the first equality we inserted the definition of the module braiding $\overleftarrow{\sigma} \circ \overrightarrow{\sigma}$, and we used the hexagons in Definition 2.16 in the second equality. The identity (2.7b) follows from

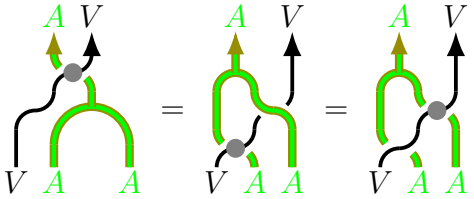


(2.40)

with the first equality being the definition of the module braiding and the second following from the hexagons and naturality of the small braidings. □

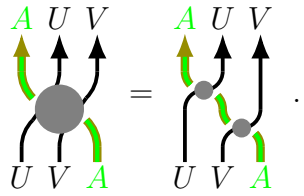
Let (A, m, u) be an algebra in $\mathcal{D}$. By virtue of $\mathcal{C}$ being a monoidal subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$, the category $\mathcal{D}_A$ is a $\mathcal{C}$-module category. The following proposition adapts one direction of Proposition 2.9 in order to define a module braiding for $\mathcal{D}_A$ from a half-braiding for A. The proof is exactly the same as in Proposition 2.9. For $A \in \mathcal{D}$, we define a half-braiding $\widehat{\gamma}^A$ to be a natural isomorphism $\iota \otimes A \Rightarrow A \otimes \iota$ which satisfies the hexagon [EGNO15, Eq. (7.41)] with ι and its monoidal structure inserted where appropriate.

Proposition 2.19. Let (A, m, u) be an algebra in $\mathcal{D}$. A half-braiding $\widehat{\gamma}^A : \iota \otimes A \Rightarrow A \otimes \iota$ satisfying



(2.41)

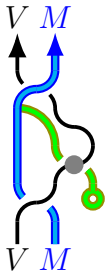
and



(2.42)

for all $U, V \in \mathcal{C}$, equips the $\mathcal{C}$-module category $\mathcal{D}_A$ with a module braiding given by

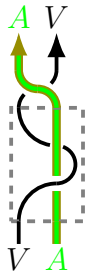
$e_{V,M} :=$



(2.43)

Remark 2.20. It is not clear to us if one can construct a half-braiding given a module braiding for $\mathcal{D}_A$: The inverse for the construction out of which one would wish to obtain a half-braiding is

$\widehat{\gamma}^A_V =$



(2.44)

The first equality in (2.41) follows from each $e_{V,A}$ being a morphism in $\mathcal{D}_A$ and the fact that the small braidings are natural. We do not know how to prove the second equality from the basic properties of module braidings. That being said, we do not have an example of a module braiding for $\mathcal{D}_A$ that does not give A a half-braiding.

As in the previous subsection, we call the pair consisting of an algebra $(A, m, u) \in \mathcal{D}$ and a half-braiding $\widehat{\gamma}^A$ satisfying (2.41) a half-braided algebra in $\mathcal{D}$.

Assume that $\mathcal{C}$ is a ribbon category and that the coend of the functor $\iota((-)^* \otimes =) : \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{op}} \times \mathcal{C} \to \mathcal{D}$, denoted

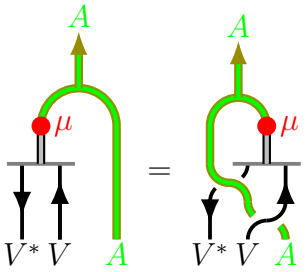
$$\mathcal{L} := \int^{V \in \mathcal{C}} \iota(V^* \otimes V) \,, \tag{2.45}$$

exists in $\mathcal{D}$, and assume that $-\otimes V$ and $V\otimes -$ preserve it for all $V \in \mathcal{D}$. The algebra structure for $\mathcal{L}$ is the same as (2.26a),(2.26b) with ι inserted where appropriate. Our assumption on preservation under $-\otimes V$ and $V\otimes -$ ensures that the algebra structure is well-defined.

Remark 2.21. Preservation of $\mathcal{L}$ under $-\otimes V$ and $V\otimes -$ is not automatic in general. The assumption holds if the tensor product preserves all colimits, or $\mathcal{D}$ is a finite tensor category in the sense of [EGNO15, Ch. 4]. We work in this more general setting as our example in Section 3.3 is not abelian, however it does satisfy the additional assumption by virtue of being closed monoidal and braided.

As we did in Proposition 2.19, we obtain one direction of the results in Proposition 2.13 and Corollary 2.14. The proof is exactly the same as in the appropriate directions of the previous subsection, with braidings being replaced by small braidings, so we omit it.

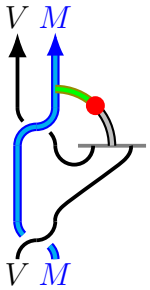
Proposition 2.22. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be ribbon, $\mathcal{D}$ contain the coend $\mathcal{L}$, and assume that $-\otimes V$ and $V\otimes -$ preserve it for all $V \in \mathcal{D}$. Let (A, m, u) be an algebra in $\mathcal{D}$. Let $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to A$ be an algebra homomorphism in $\mathcal{D}$ satisfying



(2.46)

for all $V \in \mathcal{C}$. The morphisms

$e_{V,M} =$



(2.47)

form a module braiding for $\mathcal{D}_A$. There is a bijective correspondence between such maps μ and half-braidings in the sense of Proposition 2.13.

As in the previous subsection, we refer to algebra maps $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to A$ in $\mathcal{D}$ satisfying (2.46) as quantum moment maps for A.

3 Braided module categories for quantum groups

In this section we construct examples of braided module categories and half-braided algebras/quantum moment maps coming from quantum groups. First we discuss small braidings associated to quantum groups at generic quantum parameter and introduce several concrete examples. We then change settings, and discuss small braidings coming from the $\hbar$-adic quantum group $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$. In the $\hbar$-adic setting we apply the machinery of Appendix A and the previous section to construct quantum moment maps from internal-hom algebras.

Throughout this section, fix a semisimple Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}$ of rank n. Let $\{\alpha_i\}$ be the simple roots of $\mathfrak{g}$, $\{H_i\}$ the simple coroots and P the weight lattice. Let $(-,=)$ be the standard symmetric bilinear form on $\mathfrak{h}^*$ proportional to the Killing form on $\mathfrak{g}$, and $d_i = (\alpha_i, \alpha_i)/2$. Let $A = ((\alpha_i, \alpha_j)/d_i)$ be the Cartan matrix for $\mathfrak{g}$.

3.1 Small braidings from unrolled quantum groups

We work over $\mathbb{C}$ and with quantum parameter $q \in \mathbb{C}^\times$, for which we fix a logarithm $\log q \in \mathbb{C}$. We denote $e^{a \log q}$ by q^a, where a can be a number or an operator. We denote with $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ the unrolled quantum group based on $\mathfrak{g}$, which was originally defined for $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sl}_2$ in [GPT09] and for an arbitrary semisimple Lie algebra in [GP13]. Concretely, we use the definition of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ from [Ru22, Def. 3.1], which allows for generic quantum parameter.

Let us briefly recall a few basic facts and notation. Denote $U_q\mathfrak{h}$, $U_q\mathfrak{n}_+$ and $U_q\mathfrak{n}_-$ the subalgebras of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ generated by $\{K_i^{\pm 1}\}_{i=1}^n$, $\{E_i\}_{i=1}^n$ and $\{F_i\}_{i=1}^n$, respectively, and denote the generators of $U\mathfrak{h}$ with $\{H_i\}_{i=1}^n$. The translation between the notation of [Ru22] and our notation is $K_i = K_i$, $K_{-i} = K_i^{-1}$, $X_i = E_i$ and $X_{-i} = F_i$. The generators coming from $U_q\mathfrak{n}_\pm$ act nilpotently in finite-dimensional representations. Let $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ be the subalgebra of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ generated by $U_q\mathfrak{h}$ and $U_q\mathfrak{n}_\pm$. This is the De Concini–Kac specialisation of $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ [DK90] (see also [Ru22, p. 6]), which agrees with the definition of $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ given in [KS97, Sec. 6.1.2].

Recall that a $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-module V is a *weight module* if there exist $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$ such that V has a direct sum decomposition [GP13, Sec. 5.3]

$$V \cong \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*} V_\lambda \,, \quad V_\lambda = \{v : H_i \cdot v = \lambda(H_i) v \,, \quad K_i \cdot v = q^{d_i \lambda(H_i)} \cdot v\} \,. \tag{3.1}$$

We do not demand the V_λ to be finite-dimensional.

For applications in skein theory, we are interested in defining a small braiding for the category of so-called finite-dimensional type 1 modules for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$. Recall that a $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-module V is of type 1 if there exist $\lambda \in P$ such that V has a direct sum

decomposition [CP94, p. 314] (see also [Ch94, p. 4])

$$V \cong \bigoplus_{\lambda \in P} V_\lambda \ , \quad V_\lambda = \{v : K_i \cdot v = q^{d_i \lambda(H_i)} v\} \ . \tag{3.2}$$

Let $\mathcal{D}^H$ be the full monoidal subcategory of $U_q^H \mathfrak{g}$-modules consisting of weight modules, $\mathcal{C}^H$ the full monoidal subcategory of $\mathcal{D}^H$ consisting of finite-dimensional modules, and $\mathcal{C}$ be the category of finite-dimensional $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-modules of type 1.

It is well-known that finite-dimensional $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-modules of type 1 form a braided monoidal category when q is not a root of unity, see for example [KS97, Prop. 8.19] (but there is no braiding for all finite-dimensional $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-modules; this is shown for $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sl}_2$ in [WW26]). The braiding is constructed in [KS97, Sec. 8.3.3] by defining an endomorphism of the tensor product of $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-modules which implements the action of the universal R-matrix for the $\hbar$-adic quantum group with the formal parameter being specialised to a complex number. Replacing the formal parameter with a complex number does not recover an element of the tensor square of $U_q\mathfrak{g}$, so one cannot obtain a universal R-matrix for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ this way. To get around this, one defines an element R of a completion $\widehat{U_q\mathfrak{g} \otimes U_q\mathfrak{g}}$ of the tensor square of $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ [KS97, Thm. 8.18], which contains infinite sums over powers of $U_q\mathfrak{n}_- \otimes U_q\mathfrak{n}_+ \subset \widehat{U_q\mathfrak{g} \otimes U_q\mathfrak{g}}$ generators, and an endomorphism Φ of the tensor product of $U, V \in \mathcal{C}$ which acts as $u \otimes v \mapsto q^{(\lambda,\mu)} u \otimes v$ for $u \in U_\lambda$ and $v \in V_\mu$ [KS97, Prop. 8.19], such that

$$u \otimes v \mapsto \Phi R \cdot (u \otimes v) \tag{3.3}$$

implements the action of the $\hbar$-adic R-matrix with the formal variable specialised to a complex number. Composing this with the swap operation of vector spaces then implements a braiding.

We now outline how this braiding can be extended to finite-dimensional $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules. Using the duality between $\mathfrak{h}^*$ and $\mathfrak{h}$ the endomorphism $u \otimes v \mapsto q^{(\lambda,\mu)} u \otimes v$ can be realised in terms of the generators of $U\mathfrak{h} \subset U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ [GP13, Lem. 40],

$$u \otimes v \mapsto q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i (A^{-1})_{ij} H_i \otimes H_j} \cdot u \otimes v \ . \tag{3.4}$$

This endomorphism is well-defined on the tensor product of any two weight modules for $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$, regardless of whether or not their weight supports are integral. Since $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ is a subalgebra of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$, one can ask whether the morphisms (3.3), where Φ is replaced by the endomorphism (3.4), define a braiding between finite-dimensional $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules. Because

$$q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i (A^{-1})_{ij} H_i \otimes H_j} \Delta(H_k) = \Delta(H_k) q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i (A^{-1})_{ij} H_i \otimes H_j} \tag{3.5}$$

for all $k = 1, \ldots, n$, it suffices to check $R\Delta(H_i) = \Delta^{\mathrm{op}}(H_i)R$. A straightforward computation shows this to be true.

Remark 3.1. The truncated R-matrices of [GP13, Ru22] can only be used to implement a braiding when q is a root of unity and one restricts to a certain subcategory of $\mathcal{C}^H$. Alternatively, one can take the quotient of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ by ideals generated by certain powers of the generators coming from $U_q\mathfrak{n}_\pm$ to define the restricted quantum group [GPT09, CGP15], the modules over which admit a braiding in terms of a truncated R-matrix.

Removing the assumptions on the weight support of finite-dimensional $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules U and V, the proof of [KS97, Prop. 8.19] can be adapted to show that finite-dimensional $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules form a braided monoidal category when q is not a root of unity: One only needs to replace $B_{U,V}$ of [KS97, Prop. 8.19] with (3.4). The obstruction to braiding $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-modules of arbitrary dimension is that the sum over powers of the $U_q\mathfrak{n}_- \otimes U_q\mathfrak{n}_+$ generators in the R-matrix will not truncate when acting on a tensor product of modules which are not locally finite as $U_q\mathfrak{n}_+$- or $U_q\mathfrak{n}_-$-modules, see [KS97, Thm. 8.18] for the explicit form of the R-matrix. The torsion-free modules of [FHW15] are an example of such modules. However, the sum will truncate if at least one of the modules is finite-dimensional, so one can braid a finite-dimensional module with an infinite-dimensional module. We then arrive at our first example of a small braiding. Note that it follows from [KS97, Thm. 8.18] that the hexagons (2.36a)-(2.36d) are satisfied and the small braiding morphisms are invertible.

Proposition 3.2. For all $C \in \mathcal{C}^H$ and $D \in \mathcal{D}^H$ define s to be the swap operation on tensor products of vector spaces: $s_{C,D}(c \otimes d) := d \otimes c$ for all $c \in C$ and $d \in D$. If q is not a root of unity, then the morphisms

$$\overrightarrow{\sigma}_{C,D}(c \otimes d) = s_{C,D}\left(q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i(A^{-1})_{ij}H_i\otimes H_j} R \cdot (c \otimes d)\right) \tag{3.6a}$$

$$\overleftarrow{\sigma}_{D,C}(d \otimes c) = s_{D,C}\left(q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i(A^{-1})_{ij}H_i\otimes H_j} R \cdot (d \otimes c)\right) , \tag{3.6b}$$

where R is the R-matrix for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ and s is the swap operation on vector spaces, define a small braiding on $\mathcal{C}^H \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}^H$.

The following proposition allows us to define a small braiding between finite-dimensional $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-modules of type 1 and $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules.

Proposition 3.3. Assume $q \in \mathbb{C}^\times$ is not a root of unity. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be the category of finite-dimensional $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-modules of type 1. There is a full braided monoidal inclusion of categories $\iota : \mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{C}^H$.

Proof. If q is not a root of unity the decomposition (3.2) of $V \in \mathcal{C}$ is unique as each $\lambda(H_i) \in \mathbb{Z}$ when $\lambda \in P$. Define the functor $\iota : \mathcal{C} \to \mathcal{C}^H$ to leave the underlying vector spaces of the objects and linear maps of the morphisms the same, and

define an action of the generators of $U\mathfrak{h}$ to be $H_i \cdot v = \lambda(H_i)v$ for $v \in V_\lambda$. The uniqueness of the decomposition (3.2) implies that linear maps which intertwine the $U_q\mathfrak{h}$ generators also intertwine the generators of $U\mathfrak{h}$, so ι is a well-defined functor. Furthermore the uniqueness of the decomposition implies such maps are in bijection, so ι is fully faithful. Let us now show ι is monoidal. Let $u \in U_\mu$ and $v \in V_\lambda$ for $U, V \in \mathcal{C}$. Consider $u \otimes v \in (U \otimes V)_{\mu+\lambda}$, on which the action of $K_i \in U_q\mathfrak{h}$ is given by

$$K_i \cdot (u \otimes v) = q^{d_i\mu(H_i)+d_i\lambda(H_i)} u \otimes v = q^{d_i(\mu+\lambda)(H_i)} u \otimes v \ . \tag{3.7}$$

The action of $H_i \in U\mathfrak{h}$ on $u \otimes v$ is

$$H_i \cdot (u \otimes v) = H_i \cdot u \otimes v + u \otimes H_i \cdot v = (\mu + \lambda)(H_i) u \otimes v \ , \tag{3.8}$$

as desired. We see that this inclusion is braided because of the identification of the endomorphism Φ in (3.3) with $q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i (A^{-1})_{ij} H_i \otimes H_j}$ [GP13, Lem. 40]. □

The previous two propositions now imply the main theorem of this section:

Theorem 3.4. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be the category of finite-dimensional $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-modules of type 1, $\mathcal{D}^H$ be the category of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules, and $\mathcal{C}^H$ the full subcategory of $\mathcal{D}^H$ of finite-dimensional modules. For $q \in \mathbb{C}^\times$ not a root of unity, there is a small braiding on the monoidal inclusion $\mathcal{C} \overset{\iota}{\hookrightarrow} \mathcal{C}^H \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}^H$ given by

$$\overrightarrow{\sigma}_{C,D}(c \otimes d) = s_{C,D}\Big(q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i (A^{-1})_{ij} H_i \otimes H_j} R \cdot (c \otimes d)\Big) \tag{3.9a}$$

$$\overleftarrow{\sigma}_{D,C}(d \otimes c) = s_{D,C}\Big(q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i (A^{-1})_{ij} H_i \otimes H_j} R \cdot (d \otimes c)\Big) \ , \tag{3.9b}$$

for all $C \in \mathcal{C}$, $D \in \mathcal{D}^H$, $c \in C$ and $d \in D$, where R is the R-matrix for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$.

3.2 Examples for quantum parameter not a root of unity

We fix $q \in \mathbb{C}^\times$ not a root of unity and define $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}^H$ as below (3.1). We now study subcategories of $\mathcal{D}^H$ closed under tensoring with objects in $\mathcal{C}$ in order to construct examples of braided module categories from the small braiding on $\mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}^H$ in Theorem 3.4.

In the examples that follow, the module braiding is given by the monodromy $\overleftarrow{\sigma} \circ \overrightarrow{\sigma}$, as per the prescription in Proposition 2.18. We understand the following example to be folklore and have not seen it written down anywhere in the literature. It can be viewed as an unrolled version of the quantum category $\mathcal{O}$ of [AM15].

Example 3.5. Define $\mathcal{O}_q^H$ to be the full subcategory of $\mathcal{D}^H$ consisting of modules which are finitely generated and in which $U_q\mathfrak{n}_+$ acts locally nilpotently. Tensoring with a finite-dimensional module preserves finite-generation and local $U_q\mathfrak{n}_+$-nilpotency, so $\mathcal{O}_q^H$ is closed under tensoring with $\mathcal{C}$ and thus a braided $\mathcal{C}$-module category.

For each pair $\lambda, \mu \in \mathfrak{h}^*$, say $\lambda \sim \mu$ if $\lambda - \mu \in P$. Let $W \in \mathcal{C}$ and $V \in \mathcal{D}^H$. Because the weight support of ιW is in P, for all weights μ in the support of $\iota W \otimes V$ there exists λ in the support of V such that $\mu \sim \lambda$. We then arrive at the following example of a subcategory of $\mathcal{D}^H$ closed under tensoring with objects in $\mathcal{C}$.

Example 3.6. For each $\Lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*/\sim$, the full subcategory $\mathcal{D}_\Lambda^H$ of $\mathcal{D}^H$ consisting of modules with weight support in Λ is closed under tensoring with objects in $\mathcal{C}$ and thus a braided $\mathcal{C}$-module category.

We call a weight $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$ *q-generic* if $q^{2(\lambda,\alpha)-m(\alpha,\alpha)} \neq 1$ for all positive roots α and $m \in \mathbb{Z}$. Given $p \in P$, it follows from the fact that $\frac{2(p,\alpha)}{(\alpha,\alpha)} \in \mathbb{Z}$ for all positive roots α that if λ is q-generic then so is $\lambda + p$ for all $p \in P$. We then call $\Lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*/\sim$ q-generic if its representatives $\lambda \in \Lambda$ are q-generic. Given $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$ one can define a Verma module $V^H(\lambda)$ for the unrolled quantum group analogously to the classical case [GP13, Sec. 5.5].

Lemma 3.7. Let $q \in \mathbb{C}^\times$ not be a root of unity. A Verma module $V^H(\lambda)$ is irreducible if $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$ is q-generic.

Proof. By forgetting the action of $U\mathfrak{h}$ a Verma module $V^H(\lambda)$ defines a Verma module $V(\lambda)$ for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ in the sense of [DK90, Sec. 1.9]. It follows from [DK90, Cor. 1.9] that if λ is q-generic, then $V^H(\lambda)$ is irreducible as a $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-module, hence also as a $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-module. □

Using Lemma 3.7, we define module subcategories of $\mathcal{D}_\Lambda^H$ which contain only finite direct sums of irreducible Verma modules. First we show how the tensor product of an irreducible Verma module with a finite-dimensional module decomposes as a direct sum of irreducible Verma modules.

Proposition 3.8. Let $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$ be q-generic and $V^H(\lambda)$ be a Verma module for $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$. The tensor product $\iota W \otimes V^H(\lambda)$ decomposes as

$$\iota W \otimes V^H(\lambda) \cong \bigoplus_{\mu \in \mathfrak{h}^*} V^H(\lambda + \mu)^{\oplus \dim(W_\mu)} \tag{3.10}$$

for all modules $W \in \mathcal{C}$, where $\iota W \cong \bigoplus_{\mu \in \mathfrak{h}^*} W_\mu$ is the weight space decomposition of ιW.

Proof. Given $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$ we denote with $v_\lambda \in V^H(\lambda)$ the highest weight vector. Because $U\mathfrak{h}$ acts as a scalar on each weight space, the result [ES01, Prop. 2.2] applies, meaning that for $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$ q-generic, there is for every $w \in W_\mu$ a unique intertwiner $\Phi^w_{\lambda+\mu} : V^H(\lambda+\mu) \to \iota W \otimes V^H(\lambda)$ such that

$$\Phi^w_{\lambda+\mu}(v_{\lambda+\mu}) = w \otimes v_\lambda + u \;, \tag{3.11}$$

where $u \in \bigoplus_{\nu<\lambda} \iota W \otimes V^H(\lambda)_\nu$. Combining these, we obtain an intertwiner

$$\eta^\lambda_W : \bigoplus_{\mu\in\mathfrak{h}^*} W_\mu \otimes V^H(\lambda+\mu) \to \iota W \otimes V^H(\lambda) \quad , \quad w \otimes v \mapsto \Phi^w_{\lambda+\mu}(v) \;, \tag{3.12}$$

where the action of $U^H_q\mathfrak{g}$ on $W_\mu \otimes V^H(\lambda+\mu)$ is only on the second factor. As a $U^H_q\mathfrak{g}$-module, the domain of η^λ_W is isomorphic to $\bigoplus_{\mu\in\mathfrak{h}^*} V^H(\lambda+\mu)^{\oplus \dim(W_\mu)}$. To establish (3.10), it thus remains to show that η^λ_W is an isomorphism.

We begin with injectivity of η^λ_W. First note that by construction the linear map

$$\iota W = \bigoplus_{\mu\in\mathfrak{h}^*} W_\mu \to \iota W \otimes V^H(\lambda) \;, \quad w \mapsto \Phi^w_{\lambda+\mu}(v_{\lambda+\mu}) \quad (\text{for } w \in W_\mu) \tag{3.13}$$

is injective. Because $W \in \mathcal{C}$, the weight support of ιW is integral, hence each $V^H(\lambda+\mu)$ is irreducible. It then follows that if the kernel of η^λ_W is non-zero, it must also contain an element of the form $w \otimes v_{\lambda+\mu}$, which by the above observation cannot happen.

Now we show η^λ_W is surjective. The restriction of η^λ_W to each weight space is also an injective map. Because the weight spaces of the left- and right-hand side of (3.10) are finite-dimensional, if they have equal dimension, η^λ_W is surjective. This in turn follows from

$$\begin{aligned}\dim(\iota W \otimes V^H(\lambda))_\rho &= \sum_\mu \dim(W_\mu)\dim(V^H(\lambda)_{\rho-\mu}) = \sum_\mu \dim(W_\mu)\dim(V^H(\lambda+\mu)_\rho) \\ &= \dim\Big(\bigoplus_\mu W_\mu \otimes V^H(\lambda+\mu)\Big)_\rho \;. \end{aligned} \tag{3.14}$$

□

Now we can define an example containing only direct sums of irreducible Verma modules.

Example 3.9. For each q-generic $\Lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*/\sim$ the full subcategory $\mathcal{M}^H_\Lambda$ of $\mathcal{D}^H_\Lambda$ of modules that are isomorphic to a finite direct sum of Verma modules of highest weight $\lambda \in \Lambda$ is closed under tensoring with $\mathcal{C}$, and thus a braided $\mathcal{C}$-module category.

Remark 3.10. In the case $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sl}_2$, facets of the categories $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$ have appeared in the literature before. Fix the pivotal structure for $\mathcal{C}$ which recovers the Kauffman bracket skein relations (see [Ti10] for more details) and let V be the fundamental representation of $U_q\mathfrak{sl}_2$. In this setting the Temperley–Lieb algebra on n strands is isomorphic to the endomorphism space of $V^{\otimes n} \in \mathcal{C}$. Furthermore, the hom-space from m to n in the Temperley–Lieb category is isomorphic to $\mathcal{C}(V^{\otimes m}, V^{\otimes n})$. From the results of [ILZ19], the blob algebra of [MS94] on n strands is isomorphic to the endomorphism algebra of $V^{\otimes n} \triangleright V^H(\lambda)$ in $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$. In fact, the hom-spaces of the blob category defined in [LNV21, Sec. 2.2] are given by hom-spaces of $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$. The blob category can be viewed as a module category over the Temperley–Lieb category, with the action given by concatenation. Furthermore, from the identification of the hom-spaces in the blob category with those of $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$ we observe that the blob category is a braided module category over the Temperley–Lieb category. See also [CGS22] for the relation between endomorphism spaces of $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$, the blob algebra, and boundary conditions of the XXZ spin chain.

3.3 Quantum moment maps from internal-homs

We now construct examples of quantum moment maps. In order to do this we change settings and work with the $\hbar$-adic Hopf algebra $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ over $\mathbb{C}[\![\hbar]\!]$, see [KS97, Sec. 6.1.3] for details regarding the definition. First we introduce some terminology which will let us define categories of $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules from which we can obtain quantum moment maps via small braidings. Let W be a complex vector space. Define $W[\![\hbar]\!]$ to be the $\mathbb{C}[\![\hbar]\!]$-module containing all formal series $\sum_{n\geq 0} w_n\hbar^n$, where $(w_0, w_1, \dots)$ is a sequence of elements in W (see [Ka95, Eq. (XVI.1.2)] for the $\mathbb{C}[\![\hbar]\!]$-module structure). A $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-module V is called *topologically free* if it is isomorphic as a $\mathbb{C}[\![\hbar]\!]$-module to $W[\![\hbar]\!]$, where W is a $U\mathfrak{g}$-module over $\mathbb{C}$ [Ka95, Sec. XVI.2]. A topologically free module $V \cong W[\![\hbar]\!]$ is said to be of *finite rank* if W is a finite-dimensional $U\mathfrak{g}$-module [Ka95, Sec. XVII.3]. The *completed tensor product* of $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules, $\widehat{\otimes}$, is the $\hbar$-adic completion of $\otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\hbar]}$, see [Ka95, Def. XVI.3.1]. For topologically free modules $X[\![\hbar]\!]$ and $Y[\![\hbar]\!]$ one has $X[\![\hbar]\!]\widehat{\otimes}Y[\![\hbar]\!] \cong (X \otimes Y)[\![\hbar]\!]$ as $\mathbb{C}[\![\hbar]\!]$-modules, so topologically free modules form a monoidal subcategory of $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules [Ka95, Prop. XVI.3.2]. The Hopf algebra $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ is itself topologically free, and isomorphic to $U\mathfrak{g}[\![\hbar]\!]$ as an algebra [Ka95, Thm. XVIII.4.1].

Remark 3.11. The category of topologically free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules is not abelian. Consider the endomorphism of $\mathbb{C}[\![\hbar]\!]$ given by $f : r \mapsto r\hbar$. f is injective, hence a monomorphism, and it follows from $\mathbb{C}[\![\hbar]\!]$-linearity and that the target of f is $\hbar$-torsion free that f is an epimorphism. However, f is not surjective and thus not an isomorphism, which implies topologically free modules do not form an abelian category. One workaround for this is to consider the category of $L_0^{\hbar\mathbb{C}[\hbar]}$-complete

$\mathbb{C}[\![\hbar]\!]$-modules of [PW22], which is abelian and contains topologically free modules as a monoidal subcategory [PW22, Prop. 3.9]. We do not do this in this manuscript, in favour of imposing stronger constraints on our module categories which suffice to prove the desired results.

The Hopf algebra $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ is a quasitriangular $\hbar$-adic Hopf algebra [KS97, Thm. 8.17], meaning the R-matrix $\mathcal{R} = \mathcal{R}_1 \widehat{\otimes} \mathcal{R}_2$ for $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ is an element of $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g} \widehat{\otimes} U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$. Hence acting with $\mathcal{R}$ is well-defined on any tensor product of topologically free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules, not just the finite rank ones. We then have that the category of topologically free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules is a braided monoidal category. From [Ka95, Exercise XVI.2] we also see that the category of topologically free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules is closed, with the internal-hom objects $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V)$ being given by $\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}[\![\hbar]\!]}(U, V)$. The action of $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ on $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V)$ is

$$(x \cdot f)(-) = x_{(1)} f(S(x_{(2)}) \cdot -) \tag{3.15}$$

for all $x \in U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ and $f \in \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V)$. Note that this implies the completed tensor product for $\mathcal{D}$ has a right adjoint, hence preserves existing colimits.

Now we fix our setting: Let $\mathcal{C}$ be the category of finite rank topologically free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules and $\mathcal{D}$ be the category of all topologically free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules. When we write the tensor product $\otimes$ we always mean $\widehat{\otimes}$. The small braiding on $\mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}$ is simply given by the braiding on $\mathcal{D}$. We indicate successive applications of $\mathcal{R}$ with a prime superscript. For example, the monodromy $\overleftarrow{\sigma} \circ \overrightarrow{\sigma}$ is given by

$$\overleftarrow{\sigma}_{V,U} \circ \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,V}(u \otimes v) = \mathcal{R}_2' \mathcal{R}_1 u \otimes \mathcal{R}_1' \mathcal{R}_2 v \,, \tag{3.16}$$

for all $U \in \mathcal{C}$, $V \in \mathcal{D}$ and $u \in U$, $v \in V$.

Fix a full subcategory $\mathcal{M} \subset \mathcal{D}$ which is closed under tensoring with objects in $\mathcal{C}$. We also use the fact that $\mathcal{D}$ is a closed category, and $\mathcal{C}$ is rigid [Ka95, Sec. XVII.3], which allows us to apply the results of Appendix A. Denote by $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$ the internal endomorphism algebra $(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, V), m^V_{V,V}, u_V)$ of Corollary A.4.

Proposition 3.12. For all $V \in \mathcal{D}$, the natural isomorphism $\gamma^{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}_- : - \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \Rightarrow \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes -$ defined via

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} U \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) & & \xrightarrow{\quad\Phi_{U,V}\quad} & & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes V) \\ \big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \gamma^{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}_U} & & & & \big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \overleftarrow{\sigma}_{V,U} \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,V})} \\ \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes U & \xrightarrow{\overleftarrow{\sigma}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V),U}} & U \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) & \xrightarrow{\Phi_{U,V}} & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes V) \end{array} \tag{3.17}$$

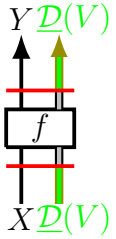
for all $U \in \mathcal{C}$ is a half-braiding for $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$. Let $M \in \mathcal{M}$ and consider $\mathcal{M}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}$ as braided module categories, with module braiding coming from the small braiding and half-braiding respectively. The functor $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M, -) : \mathcal{M} \to \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}$ is a braided $\mathcal{C}$-module functor.

Proof. Naturality of the half-braiding follows from naturality of the coherence morphisms and the small braidings. It remains to show that the half-braidings satisfy the hexagon [EGNO15, Eq. (7.41)] and that the identities (2.41) hold.

Let $X, Y \in \mathcal{C}$. Conjugating the image of a morphism $f : X \otimes V \to Y \otimes V$ under $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -)$ with the $\mathcal{C}$-module functor structure Φ for $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -)$ defines a morphism

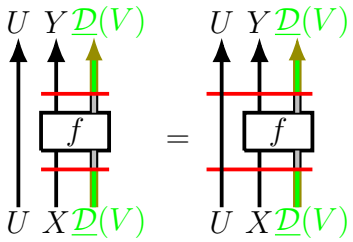
$$\underline{f} := \Phi^{-1}_{Y,V} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, f) \Phi_{X,V} : X \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \to Y \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \,. \tag{3.18}$$

We depict this as follows.

$\underline{f} =$ 

(3.19)

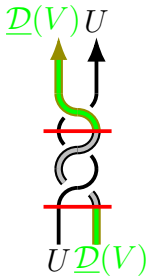
Note that $U \otimes \underline{f} = \underline{U \otimes f}$, which is depicted



(3.20)

Using this and the hexagons (2.36a) and (2.36d), it is a straightforward computation to show that $\gamma^{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}_{-}$ satisfies the hexagon [EGNO15, Eq. (7.41)].

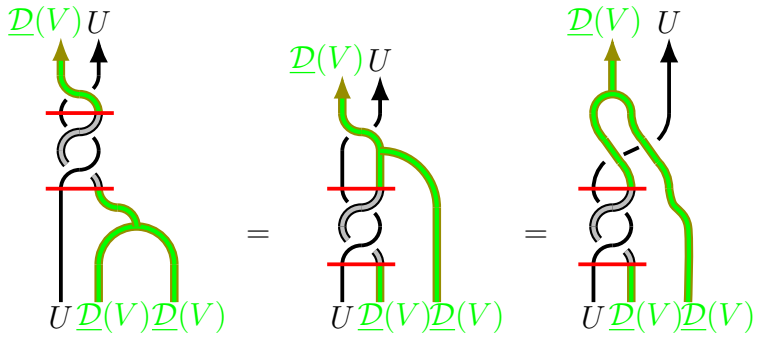
The candidate (3.17) for the half-braiding is then depicted

$\gamma^{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}_{U} =$ 

(3.21)

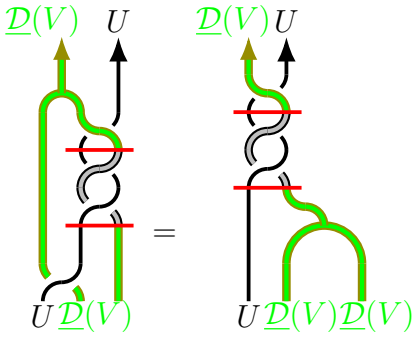
The first equality in (2.41) then follows from the fact that $\underline{f}$ is a morphism in

$\mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}$, and the naturality of the small braidings:



(3.22)

The second equality in (2.41) is depicted



(3.23)

We show that this holds via a direct calculation.

First it is useful to express the half-braiding in components. Denote by Δ, ϵ and S the coproduct, counit and antipode for $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$, respectively. Let $\mathcal{R}^{-1} = \mathcal{S}_1 \otimes \mathcal{S}_2$. Let $U \in \mathcal{C}$, $u \in U$ and $a \in \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$. Denote by $\triangleright$ the action of $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ on $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$. We have

$$\begin{aligned}\gamma_U^{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}(u \otimes a) &= [v \mapsto \mathcal{S}_1 \triangleright (\mathcal{R}'_1\mathcal{R}_2 a)(v)] \otimes \mathcal{S}_2\mathcal{R}'_2\mathcal{R}_1 u \\ &= [v \mapsto \mathcal{S}_{1(1)}\mathcal{R}'_1\mathcal{R}_2 a(S(\mathcal{S}_{1(2)})v)] \otimes \mathcal{S}_2\mathcal{R}'_2\mathcal{R}_1 u\ . \end{aligned} \tag{3.24}$$

Using the identity

$$(\Delta \otimes \mathrm{id})(\mathcal{R}^{-1})(\mathcal{R}_1 \otimes 1 \otimes \mathcal{R}_2) = (1 \otimes \mathcal{R}^{-1})(\mathcal{S}_1\mathcal{R}_1 \otimes 1 \otimes \mathcal{S}_2\mathcal{R}_2) = 1 \otimes \mathcal{R}^{-1}\ , \tag{3.25}$$

we write

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{S}_{1(1)}\mathcal{R}'_1\mathcal{R}_2 a \otimes S(\mathcal{S}_{1(2)})v \otimes \mathcal{S}_2\mathcal{R}'_2\mathcal{R}_1 u &= (\mathrm{id} \otimes S \otimes \mathrm{id})(\Delta \otimes \mathrm{id})(\mathcal{R}^{-1})(\mathcal{R}'_1\mathcal{R}_2 a \otimes v \otimes \mathcal{R}'_2\mathcal{R}_1 u) \\ &= \mathcal{R}_2 a \otimes S(\mathcal{S}_1)v \otimes \mathcal{S}_2\mathcal{R}_1 u\ . \end{aligned} \tag{3.26}$$

Hence (3.24) simplifies to

$$\gamma_U^{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}(u \otimes a) = [v \mapsto \mathcal{R}_2 a(S(\mathcal{S}_1)v)] \otimes \mathcal{S}_2\mathcal{R}_1 u\ . \tag{3.27}$$

Evaluating the left-hand side of (3.23) on any $u \otimes a \otimes b \in U \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$ results in

$$\begin{aligned} u \otimes a \otimes b &\xmapsto{\vec{\sigma}_{U,\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}} \mathcal{R}_2 \triangleright a \otimes \mathcal{R}_1 u \otimes b \\ &\xmapsto{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes \gamma_U^{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}} \mathcal{R}_2 \triangleright a \otimes [v \mapsto \mathcal{R}_2' b(S(\mathcal{S}_1)v)] \otimes \mathcal{S}_2 \mathcal{R}_1' \mathcal{R}_1 u \\ &\xmapsto{m \otimes U} [v \mapsto (\mathcal{R}_2 \triangleright a)(\mathcal{R}_2' b(S(\mathcal{S}_1)v))] \otimes \mathcal{S}_2 \mathcal{R}_1' \mathcal{R}_1 u \,. \end{aligned} \tag{3.28}$$

Using $(\mathrm{id} \otimes \Delta)(\mathcal{R}) = \mathcal{R}_1' \mathcal{R}_1 \otimes \mathcal{R}_2 \otimes \mathcal{R}_2'$, the right-hand side of (3.28) becomes

$$\begin{aligned} &[v \mapsto (\mathcal{R}_{2(1)} \triangleright a)(\mathcal{R}_{2(2)} b(S(\mathcal{S}_1)v))] \otimes \mathcal{S}_2 \mathcal{R}_1 u \\ &\quad = [v \mapsto \mathcal{R}_{2(1)} a(S(\mathcal{R}_{2(2)}) \mathcal{R}_{2(3)} b(S(\mathcal{S}_1)v))] \otimes \mathcal{S}_2 \mathcal{R}_1 u \,. \end{aligned} \tag{3.29}$$

Because $S(\mathcal{R}_{2(2)})\mathcal{R}_{2(3)} = \epsilon(\mathcal{R}_{2(2)})$, this becomes

$$[v \mapsto \mathcal{R}_2 (a \circ b)(S(\mathcal{S}_1)v)] \otimes \mathcal{S}_2 \mathcal{R}_1 u \,. \tag{3.30}$$

Evaluating the right-hand side of (3.23), we find

$$\gamma_U^{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)} \circ (U \otimes m)(u \otimes a \otimes b) = [v \mapsto \mathcal{R}_2 (a \circ b)(S(\mathcal{S}_1)v)] \otimes \mathcal{S}_2 \mathcal{R}_1 u \,. \tag{3.31}$$

So (3.23) holds, as desired.

The proof that $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M, -)$ is a braided module functor follows from an almost identical computation. To check that (2.8) is satisfied all one needs to do is to replace the left $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)$ strand in (3.23) with a $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)$-module, and apply the unit to the right strand. □

Remark 3.13. Let H be a quasitriangular Hopf algebra over a commutative ring K. Proposition 3.12 also holds for $\mathcal{D}$ being the category of H-modules and $\mathcal{C}$ the full subcategory of rigid objects in $\mathcal{D}$, with the monoidal structure given by the tensor product over K. The proof is exactly the same.

It is well-known that $\mathcal{C}$ is a ribbon category, see for example [Ka95, Sec. XVII.3]. Furthermore, the coend $\mathcal{L} = \int^{V \in \mathcal{C}} V^* \otimes V$ exists in $\mathcal{D}$, and is given by the so-called *braided dual* [Ke23, p. 26] (see also [BZBJ18a, Sec. 6] for the braided dual in a related setting). Because $\mathcal{D}$ is closed monoidal, the functors $- \otimes V$ are left adjoint to $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -)$ for all $V \in \mathcal{D}$, hence they preserve colimits and thus coends, namely $\mathcal{L}$. $\mathcal{D}$ is braided, so $- \otimes V \cong V \otimes -$ for all $V \in \mathcal{D}$, which implies $V \otimes -$ also preserves $\mathcal{L}$. Applying Proposition 2.22 to the half-braiding (3.17), we arrive at the following source of quantum moment maps coming from $U_\hbar \mathfrak{g}$-modules.

Theorem 3.14. Let $\mathcal{D}$ be the category of topologically free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules, $\mathcal{C}$ the category of finite rank topologically free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules, and $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \in \mathcal{D}$ the internal endomorphism algebra of $V \in \mathcal{D}$. For all $V \in \mathcal{D}$, the morphism $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$ defined via

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} U^* \otimes U & \xrightarrow{(U^*\otimes U)\otimes u_V} & (U^* \otimes U) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & U^* \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes V) \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle i_U} & & & & \\ \mathcal{L} & & & & \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle U^*\otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \overleftarrow{\sigma}_{V,U} \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,V})} \\ \vdots{\scriptstyle \mu} & & & & \\ \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) & \xleftarrow[\mathrm{ev}_U \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)]{} & (U^* \otimes U) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) & \xleftarrow[\sim]{} & U^* \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes V) \end{array} \tag{3.32}$$

is a quantum moment map.

Remark 3.15. The quantum moment maps $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$ are related to the quantised conjugacy classes of Lie groups defined in [Mu07]. To see this, we begin by writing the explicit form of $\mu \circ i_U(f \otimes u)$ as an endomorphism of V. This is

$$\mu \circ i_U(f \otimes u) = (v \mapsto f(\mathcal{R}_2' \mathcal{R}_1 u)\mathcal{R}_1' \mathcal{R}_2 v) \tag{3.33}$$

for all $v \in V$. The map

$$\varphi : \mathcal{L} \to U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}\ , \quad i_U(f \otimes u) \mapsto f(\mathcal{R}_2' \mathcal{R}_1 u)\mathcal{R}_1' \mathcal{R}_2 \tag{3.34}$$

is precisely [Mu07, Eq. (21)]. Let $\rho_V : U_\hbar\mathfrak{g} \to \mathrm{End}_{\mathbb{C}[\![\hbar]\!]}(V)$ be the $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-module structure of V. The map [Mu07, Eq. (23)] is not available in our setting as the module $M_{\mathfrak{p},\lambda/2\hbar}$ in [Mu07] is not in $\mathcal{D}$, see [Mu07, Rem. 3.3]. We remark however that the composition $\rho_V \circ \varphi$ coincides with μ defined via (3.33), and closely resembles [Mu07, Eq. (23)], suggesting that the quantised conjugacy classes of [Mu07] may conceptually be thought of as internal endomorphism algebras in an appropriate category of modules for the $\hbar$-adic quantum group.

The representation theory of topologically free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ weight modules is analogous to the theory of $U\mathfrak{g}$-modules. That is to say, the examples in Section 3.2 make sense here as well. Denote by $V_\hbar(\lambda)$ a Verma module for $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ of highest weight $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$, see for example [Mu07, Sec. 3.1] for a definition of Verma modules for the $\hbar$-adic quantum group. Moreover, we can now define quantum moment maps for these examples. The irreducibility criterion for Verma modules is different however, namely it is the same as for $U\mathfrak{g}$-modules. Replacing q-generic with generic in the sense of [Mu07, Sec. 3.2] (which is also invariant under shifts by weights in P), the tensor product decomposition of Proposition 3.8 follows from [Mu07, Prop. 3.7]. Hence we define $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda$ to be the full subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$ whose objects are

isomorphic to finite direct sums of Verma modules with highest weight $\lambda \in \Lambda$ where $\Lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*/\sim$ is generic. Because of the decomposition in (3.10), for all $M \in \mathcal{M}_\Lambda$ and $\lambda \in \Lambda$ there exists $W \in \mathcal{C}$ such that M is a direct summand (hence retract) of $W \otimes V_\hbar(\lambda)$, which implies $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda$ satisfies the conditions of $\mathcal{M}$ in Proposition A.7. Upon applying Proposition A.7 and Theorem 3.14 we obtain inclusions of braided module categories from $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda$:

Proposition 3.16. For all $\lambda \in \Lambda$, consider $\mathcal{D}_{A_\lambda}$ where $A_\lambda = \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V_\hbar(\lambda))$, as a braided $\mathcal{C}$-module category, with the braiding coming from the quantum moment map obtained via Proposition 2.22. There is a full inclusion of braided module categories $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V_\hbar(\lambda), -) : \mathcal{M}_\Lambda \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}_{A_\lambda}$.

Remark 3.17. The functor $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V_\hbar(\lambda), -)$ is not essentially surjective: For example, the full dual $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V_\hbar(\lambda), \mathbb{C}[\![\hbar]\!])$ of the Verma module $V_\hbar(\lambda)$ is not isomorphic to $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V_\hbar(\lambda), N)$ for any $N \in \mathcal{M}_\Lambda$. This follows from the fact that the full dual has a lowest weight $-\lambda$, whereas $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V_\hbar(\lambda), N)$ for non-zero N does not have a lowest weight. Hence $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V_\hbar(\lambda), -)$ is not an equivalence of braided module categories.

A Closed monoidal categories

We recall the definition and some basic facts about closed monoidal categories. We refer the reader to [EK66] for proofs of the general statements.

Definition A.1. [EK66, Sec. II.2 & Thm. II.5.3] A monoidal category $\mathcal{D}$ is *closed* if the functor $- \otimes V : \mathcal{D} \to \mathcal{D}$ has a right adjoint $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -)$ for all $V \in \mathcal{D}$. That is, for all $U, V, W \in \mathcal{D}$ there is a natural isomorphism $\mathcal{D}(U \otimes V, W) \cong \mathcal{D}(U, \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, W))$.

Let $\mathcal{D}$ be a closed monoidal category in the remainder of the appendix. Given $f \in \mathcal{D}(U \otimes V, W)$ we denote with $f' \in \mathcal{D}(U, \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, W))$ the image of f under the isomorphism $\mathcal{D}(U \otimes V, W) \to \mathcal{D}(U, \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, W))$. The internal-hom objects $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, W)$ come equipped with extra structure, which we now describe. The proofs of Lemmas A.2 and A.3 can be found in [EK66, Sec. II.3].

For each $V \in \mathcal{D}$, define the canonical natural transformations

$$\mathrm{ev}_{V,-} : \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -) \otimes V \Rightarrow - \quad \text{and} \quad \mathrm{coev}_{-,V} : - \Rightarrow \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, - \otimes V) \tag{A.1}$$

to be the images of the identity morphisms under the isomorphisms

$$\mathcal{D}(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -), \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -)) \Rightarrow \mathcal{D}(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -) \otimes V, -) \,, \tag{A.2}$$

and

$$\mathcal{D}(- \otimes V, - \otimes V) \Rightarrow \mathcal{D}(-, \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, - \otimes V)) \,, \tag{A.3}$$

respectively.

Lemma A.2. The natural transformations $\mathrm{ev}_{V,-}$ and $\mathrm{coev}_{-,V}$ are such that the diagrams

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U & \xrightarrow{f'} & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,W) \\ & {\scriptstyle \mathrm{coev}_{U,V}} \searrow & \uparrow{\scriptstyle \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,f)} \\ & & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,U\otimes V) \end{array} \quad , \qquad \begin{array}{ccc} U\otimes V & \xrightarrow{f} & W \\ & {\scriptstyle f'\otimes V} \searrow & \uparrow{\scriptstyle \mathrm{ev}_{V,W}} \\ & & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,W)\otimes V \end{array} \tag{A.4}$$

commute for all $U,V,W \in \mathcal{D}$ and $f \in \mathcal{D}(U\otimes V, W)$.

For all $U,V,W \in \mathcal{D}$ there are canonical morphisms

$$m^W_{U,V} : \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,V)\otimes\underline{\mathcal{D}}(W,U) \to \underline{\mathcal{D}}(W,V)\ , \tag{A.5}$$

given by the image of

$$\mathrm{ev}_{U,V}\circ(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,V)\otimes \mathrm{ev}_{W,U}) : \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,V)\otimes(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(W,U)\otimes W) \to V \tag{A.6}$$

under the isomorphism

$$\mathcal{D}(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,V)\otimes(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(W,U)\otimes W),V) \to \mathcal{D}(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,V)\otimes\underline{\mathcal{D}}(W,U),\underline{\mathcal{D}}(W,V))\ . \tag{A.7}$$

Lemma A.3. For all $U,V,W,X \in \mathcal{D}$, the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,V)\otimes\underline{\mathcal{D}}(X,U) & & \\ & {\scriptstyle \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,V)\otimes m^X_{W,U}} \nearrow & & \searrow {\scriptstyle m^X_{U,V}} & \\ \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,V)\otimes(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(W,U)\otimes\underline{\mathcal{D}}(X,W)) & & & & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(X,V) \\ {\scriptstyle\sim}\downarrow & & & & \uparrow{\scriptstyle m^X_{W,V}} \\ (\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,V)\otimes\underline{\mathcal{D}}(W,U))\otimes\underline{\mathcal{D}}(X,W) & & \xrightarrow[m^W_{U,V}\otimes\underline{\mathcal{D}}(X,W)]{} & & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(W,V)\otimes\underline{\mathcal{D}}(X,W) \end{array} \tag{A.8}$$

Denote with u_V the composition

$$\mathbb{1} \xrightarrow{\mathrm{coev}_{\mathbb{1},V}} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,\mathbb{1}\otimes V) \xrightarrow{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,l_V)} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,V) =: \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)\ . \tag{A.9}$$

Using Lemmas A.2 and A.3 we construct algebras and bimodules in $\mathcal{D}$ from the internal-hom objects:

Corollary A.4. Each tuple $(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V), m^V_{V,V}, u_V)$ is an algebra in $\mathcal{D}$, which we refer to simply as $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$. Each tuple $(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,V), m^U_{V,V}, m^U_{U,V})$ is a $(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V),\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U))$-bimodule in $\mathcal{D}$.

Define the natural transformation $\Phi^{\equiv}_{-,=} : - \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(\equiv, =) \to \underline{\mathcal{D}}(\equiv, - \otimes =)$ via the composition

$$\Phi^U_{V,W} : V \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,W) \xrightarrow{\mathrm{coev}_{V,W} \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,W)} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(W, V \otimes W) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,W) \xrightarrow{m^U_{W,V\otimes W}} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V \otimes W) \ . \tag{A.10}$$

The following lemma is an analogue of [EGNO15, Lem. 7.9.4] in our setting.

Lemma A.5. The natural transformation $\Phi^{=}_{V,-}$ is an isomorphism if and only if V has a left dual in $\mathcal{D}$.

Proof. Let $U, V, W \in \mathcal{D}$ and assume V has a left dual. For all $X \in \mathcal{D}$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{D}(X \otimes U, V \otimes W) &\cong \mathcal{D}(V^* \otimes (X \otimes U), W) \\ &\cong \mathcal{D}((V^* \otimes X) \otimes U, W) \\ &\cong \mathcal{D}(V^* \otimes X, \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,W)) \\ &\cong \mathcal{D}(X, V \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,W)) \ . \end{aligned} \tag{A.11}$$

By definition of the internal-hom, we also have

$$\mathcal{D}(X \otimes U, V \otimes W) \cong \mathcal{D}(X, \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V \otimes W)) \ . \tag{A.12}$$

Hence, by the Yoneda Lemma, we have $V \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,W) \cong \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V \otimes W)$. Furthermore, this isomorphism exhibits $V \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,W)$ as representing $\mathcal{D}(- \otimes U, V \otimes W)$, making it exactly $\Phi^U_{V,W}$.

Assume $\Phi^{=}_{V,-}$ is an isomorphism. Let $V \in \mathcal{D}$ and consider the object $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \mathbb{1})$. We have evaluation and coevaluation morphisms given by

$$\mathrm{ev}_V := \mathrm{ev}_{V,\mathbb{1}} : \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \mathbb{1}) \otimes V \to \mathbb{1} \tag{A.13}$$

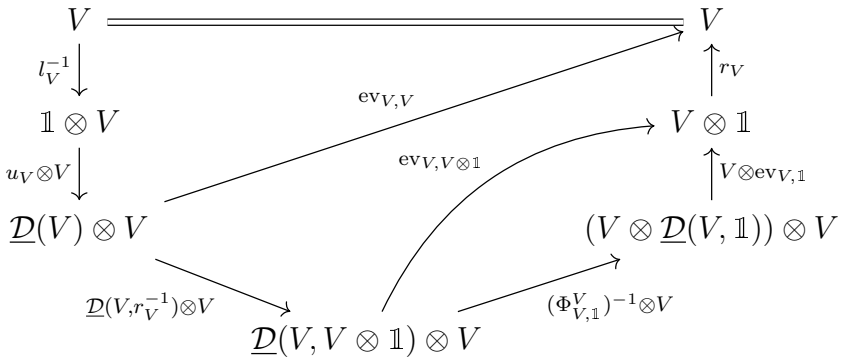
and

$$\mathrm{coev}_V : \mathbb{1} \xrightarrow{u_V} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \xrightarrow{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, r_V^{-1})} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, V \otimes \mathbb{1}) \xrightarrow{(\Phi^V_{V,\mathbb{1}})^{-1}} V \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \mathbb{1}) \ . \tag{A.14}$$

We need to check the zig-zag identities. For brevity we will suppress the associators in what follows. We will check the identity

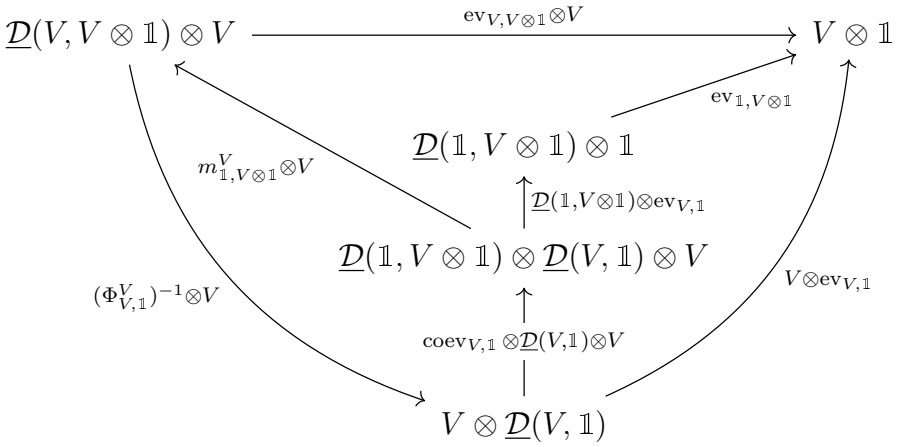
$$\begin{array}{ccc} V & = & V \\ {\scriptstyle l_V^{-1}}\downarrow & & \uparrow{\scriptstyle r_V} \\ \mathbb{1} \otimes V & & V \otimes \mathbb{1} \\ & {\scriptstyle \mathrm{coev}_V \otimes V} \searrow \quad \nearrow {\scriptstyle V \otimes \mathrm{ev}_V} & \\ & (V \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \mathbb{1})) \otimes V & \end{array} \ . \tag{A.15}$$

The other identity follows via a similar computation. The diagram (A.15) is equivalent to the outside pentagon of



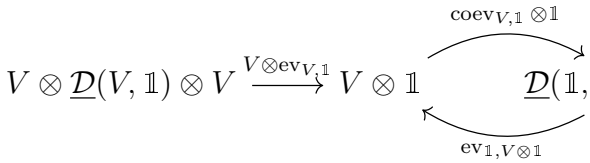
(A.16)

The square in the top left of (A.16) commutes from the second diagram in Lemma A.2 and the definition of u_V, and the square in the middle from the naturality of $\mathrm{ev}_{V,-}$. It remains to show that the bottom right triangle in (A.16) commutes. This triangle is the outside of the diagram



(A.17)

The triangle on the bottom left of (A.17) commutes by the definition of $\Phi^V_{V,\mathbb{1}}$, and the upper left square of (A.17) commutes from the definition of $m^V_{\mathbb{1},V\otimes\mathbb{1}}$ and the second diagram in Lemma A.2. The remaining square in (A.17) can be reshaped into



(A.18)

The loop in (A.18) is a special case of [EK66, Eq. (3.6)], so (A.17) commutes. □

Let $\mathcal{C} \subset \mathcal{D}$ be a full rigid monoidal subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$. For the remainder of the appendix, fix a full subcategory $\mathcal{M} \subset \mathcal{D}$ which is closed under tensoring with objects in $\mathcal{C}$, making $\mathcal{M}$ a $\mathcal{C}$-module category. Given $M \in \mathcal{M}$, we consider the algebra $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)$ and the $\mathcal{D}$-module category $\mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}$. By virtue of the fact that $\mathcal{C}$ is a monoidal subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$, the category $\mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}$ is also a $\mathcal{C}$-module category. Consider the functor $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,-) : \mathcal{M} \to \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}$. The following is a corollary of Lemma A.5.

Corollary A.6. Given $M \in \mathcal{M}$, the natural isomorphism $\Phi^M_{-,=}$ gives the functor

$$\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,-) : \mathcal{M} \to \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)} \ , \quad N \mapsto \underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,N) \tag{A.19}$$

the structure of a $\mathcal{C}$-module functor.

An object $N \in \mathcal{M}$ is said to be a retract of an object $M \in \mathcal{M}$ if there exist morphisms $s : N \to M$ and $p : M \to N$ such that $p \circ s = \mathrm{id}_N$. The following proposition is in the spirit of the characterisation given in [EGNO15, Thm. 7.10.1] in the non-finite and non-rigid setting.

Proposition A.7. Assume there exists an $M \in \mathcal{M}$ such that every $N \in \mathcal{M}$ is a retract of $U \otimes M$ for some $U \in \mathcal{C}$. The $\mathcal{C}$-module functor $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,-) : \mathcal{M} \to \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}$ is fully faithful.

Proof. Say $N \in \mathcal{M}$ is of the form $V \otimes M$ for some $V \in \mathcal{C}$. Given $L \in \mathcal{M}$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M, V \otimes M), \underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,L)) &\cong \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}(V \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(M), \underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,L)) \\ &\cong \mathcal{D}(V, \underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,L)) \\ &\cong \mathcal{M}(V \otimes M, L) \\ &= \mathcal{M}(N,L) \ , \end{aligned} \tag{A.20}$$

where the second line follows from the fact that $\mathcal{D}_A(X \otimes A, B) \cong \mathcal{D}(X,B)$ for all $X \in \mathcal{D}$, and any algebra $A \in \mathcal{D}$, and all $B \in \mathcal{D}_A$. As the $\mathcal{C}$-module structure $\Phi^M_{-,=}$ is defined via the adjunction data for $- \otimes M$ and $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,-)$, this isomorphism is the map induced by $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,-)$.

Define $F := \underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,-)$ and denote by $\phi_{N,L}$ the canonical maps $\mathcal{M}(N,L) \to \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}(F(N),F(L))$, which per (A.20) are isomorphisms when $N \cong V \otimes M$ for some $V \in \mathcal{C}$. Say $N \in \mathcal{M}$ is a retract of $U \otimes M$ for some $U \in \mathcal{C}$. Consider the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \mathcal{M}(N,L) & \xrightarrow{p^*} & \mathcal{M}(U \otimes M, L) & \xrightarrow{s^*} & \mathcal{M}(N,L) \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \phi_{N,L}} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \phi_{U\otimes M,L}} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \phi_{N,L}} \\ \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}(F(N),F(L)) & \xrightarrow{F(p)^*} & \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}(F(U\otimes M),F(L)) & \xrightarrow{F(s)^*} & \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}(F(N),F(L)) \end{array} \ . \tag{A.21}$$

Functoriality of F implies that the diagram commutes. Since $p \circ s = \mathrm{id}_N$, composition along both rows is the identity. Define

$$\rho_{N,L} := s^* \circ \phi^{-1}_{U\otimes M,L} \circ F(p)^* : \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}(F(N), F(L)) \to \mathcal{M}(N, L) \,. \tag{A.22}$$

Commutativity of (A.21) implies $\phi_{N,L} \circ \rho_{N,L} = \mathrm{id}$ and $\rho_{N,L} \circ \phi_{N,L} = \mathrm{id}$. Thus $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M, -)$ is fully faithful. □

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